

ARCUS

FP&A; Planning, Budgeting,
Forecasting and Scenario
Modelling System

Developer Software Requirements Document

Financial Planning | Budgeting | Rolling Forecasting | Scenario Modelling | Management Analysis

Field	Detail
Module	Arcus FP&A Planning, Budgeting, Forecasting and Scenario Modelling
Product Area	Finance, Planning, Analysis, Management Reporting and Scenario Modelling
Target Users	CFOs, FP&A managers, finance analysts, budget owners, executives and portfolio finance teams
Purpose	Provide a controlled planning workspace that connects actuals, budgets, forecasts, scenarios, workflows and reporting.
Implementation Principle	Spreadsheet-style planning flexibility with ERP-grade calculation, governance, collaboration and audit controls.

CONFIDENTIAL - Developer Specification

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1. PURPOSE

Developers must build the Arcus FP&A Planning, Budgeting, Forecasting and Scenario Modelling System as the forward-looking financial planning layer of Arcus.

The system must allow finance teams to convert:

```
graph TD; A[Historical Financial Results] -- "+" --> B[Operational Data]; B -- "+" --> C[Management Assumptions]; C -- "+" --> D[Business Drivers]; D -- "↓" --> E[Financial Plans]; E -- "↓" --> F[Budgets]; F -- "↓" --> G[Forecasts]; G -- "↓" --> H[Scenarios]; H -- "↓" --> I[Management Analysis]; I -- "↓" --> J[Approved Financial Outlook];
```

Historical Financial Results
+
Operational Data
+
Management Assumptions
+
Business Drivers
↓
Financial Plans
↓
Budgets
↓
Forecasts
↓
Scenarios
↓
Management Analysis
↓
Approved Financial Outlook

The system must support:

- Annual budgeting.
- Quarterly forecasting.
- Rolling forecasting.
- Long-range planning.
- Scenario modelling.
- Driver-based planning.
- Departmental planning.
- Revenue planning.
- Workforce planning.
- Expense planning.
- Capital expenditure planning.
- Working-capital planning.
- Cash-flow planning.
- Portfolio-company forecasts.
- Actual-versus-budget analysis.
- Actual-versus-forecast analysis.
- Variance commentary.
- Management reporting.
- Board reporting.
- Planning workflow and approval.
- AI-assisted analysis.

The system must not be implemented as an Excel file uploaded to Arcus or as a collection of forms where users manually type forecast numbers.

The system must operate as a controlled, multi-dimensional financial planning environment.

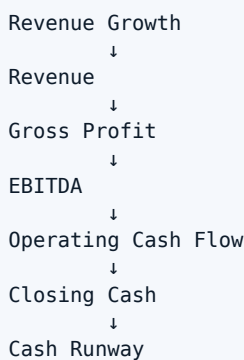
2. PLAIN-ENGLISH EXPLANATION FOR DEVELOPERS

Accounting answers: What has already happened?

FP&A answers: What is likely to happen next, why will it happen, and what should management do about it?

Consider a company with January revenue of US\$2.4m, payroll of US\$850k, other expenses of US\$900k and closing cash of US\$6.8m. Management may want to know what happens if revenue falls by 15%, salaries increase by 10%, the ZiG exchange rate moves, customers take 60 days to pay, or the company hires 20 more staff.

A user should not manually recalculate the whole financial model. The system must understand the dependency chain:



When a finance user changes Revenue Growth from 8% to 3%, the system must automatically recalculate every affected downstream value. This is the central design principle.

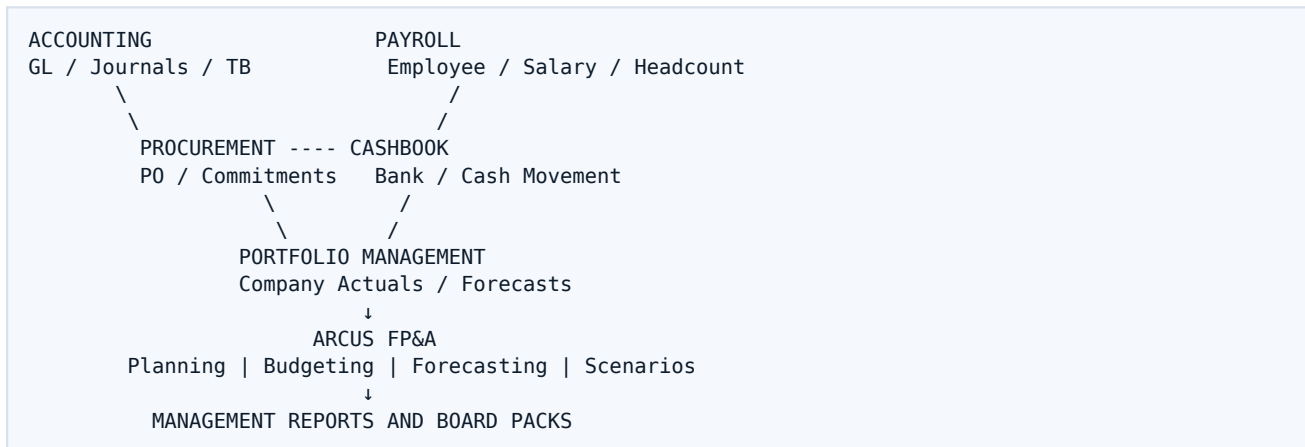
3. CORE DEVELOPMENT PRINCIPLE

The system must give users spreadsheet-style planning flexibility, enterprise financial controls, multi-user collaboration, controlled calculations, version governance and complete audit history.

The user experience may feel familiar to a spreadsheet user. The underlying architecture must not behave like a spreadsheet.

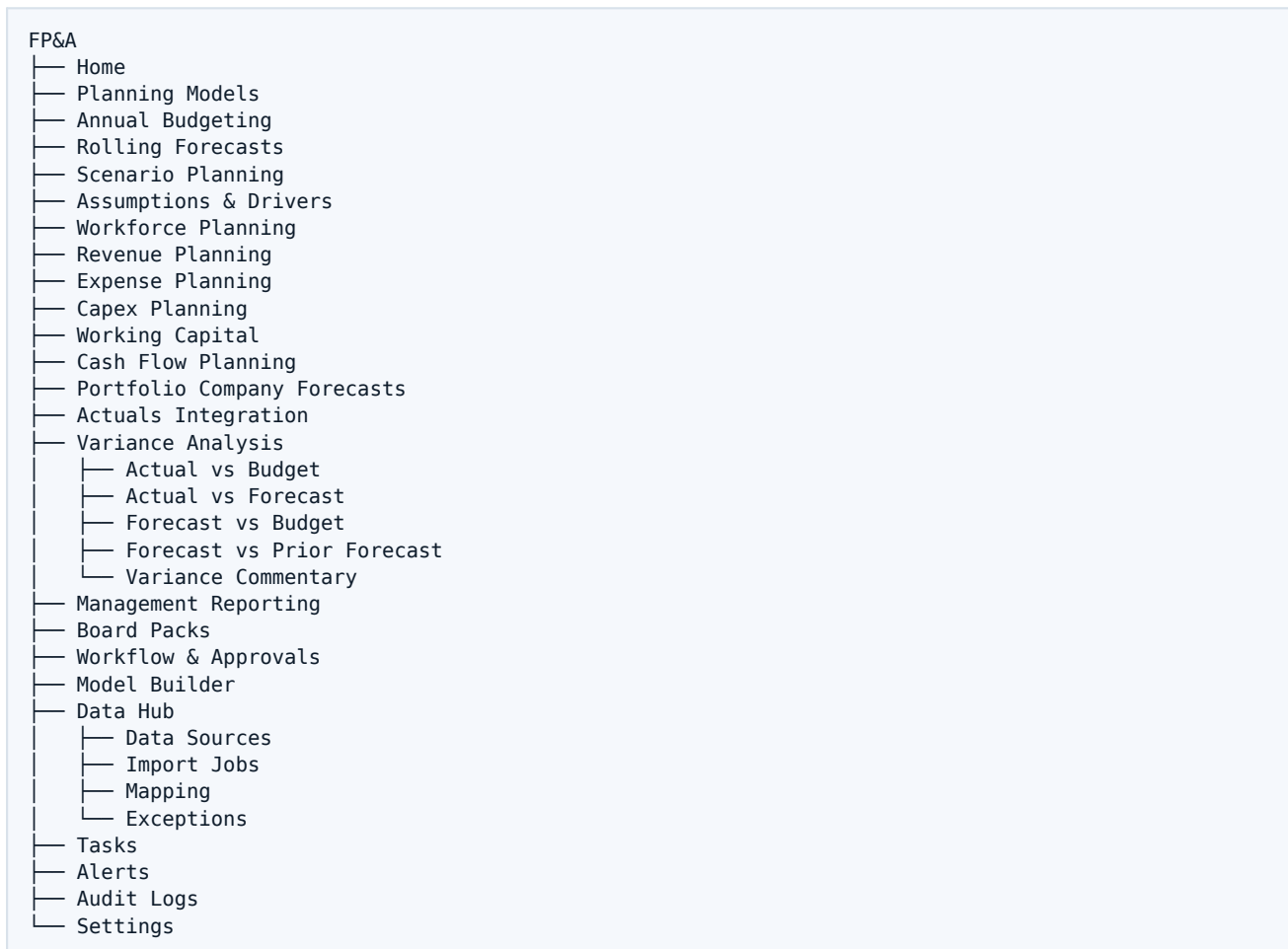
4. SYSTEM BOUNDARY

FP&A sits above operational Arcus modules. It does not replace Accounting, Payroll, Procurement, Cashbook or Portfolio Management. It consumes approved operational information as planning inputs.



FP&A may import, map, analyse and compare source actuals against plan. It must not rewrite approved accounting journals or source-system records.

5. APPLICATION NAVIGATION



6. CORE FP&A; TERMINOLOGY

6.1 Actual

A realised financial or operational value. Example: January 2027 Payroll Actual = US\$842,600. Actuals normally originate from approved source systems and must be read-only after the relevant source period is locked.

6.2 Budget

The formally approved financial plan. A budget may move through DRAFT, SUBMITTED, UNDER_REVIEW, APPROVED, LOCKED and ARCHIVED states.

6.3 Forecast

Management's current expected financial outcome. A forecast changes as actual data, assumptions and new business information become available.

6.4 Rolling Forecast

A forecast that maintains a fixed future horizon. For an 18-month rolling forecast, when February closes, February becomes Actual and a new future month is added so the forward horizon remains 18 months.

6.5 Scenario

An alternative assumption environment such as Base Case, Upside, Downside, Severe Downside, FX Shock, Hiring Freeze, Cost Reduction, Fundraising Case or Expansion Case.

6.6 Version

A saved planning dataset such as FY2027 Budget Draft v1, FY2027 Board Approved Budget or Forecast Q3. Scenario and Version are not interchangeable. Forecast Q3 / Downside is different from FY2027 Budget / Downside.

6.7 Driver

An assumption that causes another value to change, such as sales volume, product price, churn, salary increase, headcount, inflation, exchange rate, collection days or payment days.

6.8 Line Item

A financial or operational measure such as Revenue, Headcount, Average Salary, Marketing Expense, Accounts Receivable, EBITDA or Closing Cash.

7. DATA ADDRESSING AND DIMENSION MODEL

Every planning value must have a complete analytical address. A value of 100,000 has no useful meaning by itself.

Model	FY2027 Corporate Plan
Version	Forecast Q2
Scenario	Base Case
Period	July 2027
Entity	Arcus Zimbabwe
Department	Technology
Cost Centre	Software Development
Account	6200
Line Item	Cloud Infrastructure
Currency	USD
Source	Planning Input
Value	100,000

This complete address is the planning intersection.

7.1 Standard Dimensions

- Time.

- Version.
- Scenario.
- Currency.

7.2 Configurable Dimensions

- Entity.
- Department.
- Cost Centre.
- Account.
- Product.
- Project.
- Employee.
- Position.
- Region.
- Branch.
- Customer Segment.
- Channel.
- Portfolio Company.
- Fund.
- Business Unit.

7.3 Sparse Value Storage

Do not create every theoretical cell. A model with 12 months, 1,000 accounts, 100 departments, 20 entities and 5 scenarios creates 120,000,000 potential intersections. The database must use sparse storage and only store inputs, imported values, overrides, materialised calculated values where required and calculation cache.

8. USER ROLES AND PERMISSIONS

Role	Why They Use the System	Main Permissions
CFO / Finance Director	Owns final financial outlook.	View all plans; compare scenarios; approve budgets and forecasts; approve material drivers; lock versions; generate Board packs.
FP&A Manager	Coordinates planning process.	Create cycles; configure drivers; create scenarios; assign owners; review submissions; consolidate plans.
Financial Analyst	Detailed modelling and analysis.	Update assumptions; maintain forecasts; analyse variances; prepare reports; investigate calculations.
Department Head / Budget Owner	Owns departmental plan.	View and update authorised areas; plan headcount and spend; add commentary; submit plan.
Executive / Board User	Reviews approved outlook.	View approved forecasts, budgets, scenarios and Board dashboards.
System Administrator	Manages technical platform.	Configure users, integrations and platform settings; no finance approval authority by default.

Examples of department owners include Tariro Moyo - Sales Director, Nyasha Chikore - Marketing Director, Tinashe Ncube - Head of Operations and Rudo Nyathi - Head of Technology.

9. END-TO-END FP&A; OPERATING FLOW

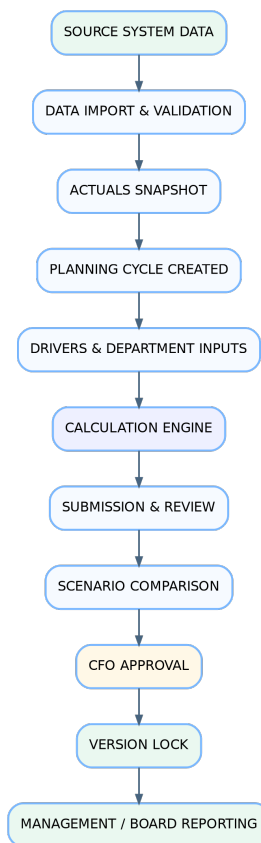


Figure 1: End-to-end FP&A; operating flow from source data to locked planning version and management reporting.

10. MODULE 1 - FP&A; HOME DASHBOARD

10.1 Why This Screen Exists

The CFO and FP&A Manager must be able to understand the current financial outlook without opening a planning grid. The dashboard must answer how the organisation is performing, what the latest forecast is, where the major risks are, how much cash remains, which departments are off plan and what requires approval.

10.2 Required KPI Cards

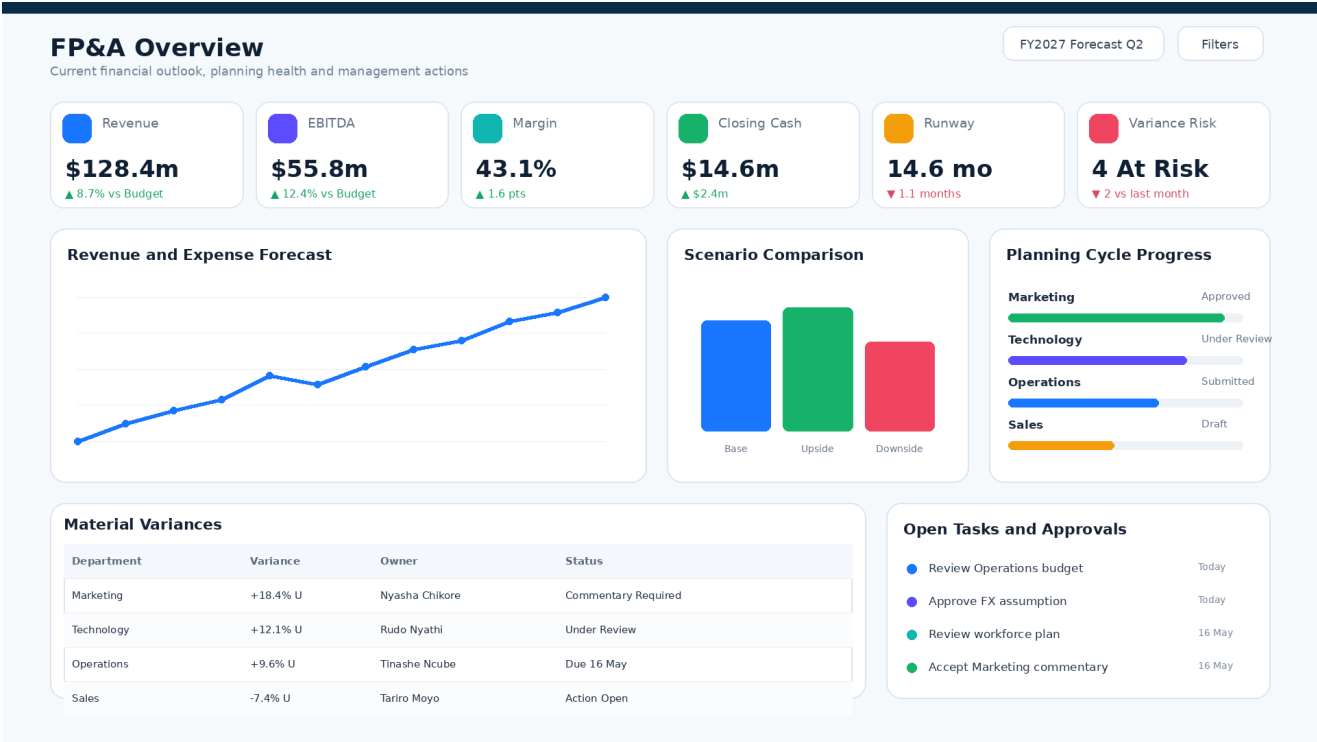
- Forecast Revenue.
- EBITDA.
- EBITDA Margin.
- Closing Cash.
- Cash Runway.
- Headcount.
- Variance to Budget.
- Variance Risk.

FORECAST REVENUE	US\$128.4m	▲ 8.7% vs Budget
EBITDA	US\$55.8m	▲ 12.4% vs Budget
CASH RUNWAY	14.6 Months	▼ 1.1 Months
HEADCOUNT	568	▲ 56 vs Budget

10.3 Forecast Health Indicators

The dashboard should calculate ON TRACK, WATCH, AT RISK and CRITICAL management indicators using configurable thresholds. Indicators are management signals and must not approve or reject plans automatically.

10.4 Dashboard Wireframe



UI Inspiration 1: FP&A; Executive Home. White, high-density planning dashboard designed for a 13.5-inch finance workstation.

11. MODULE 2 - PLANNING MODEL AND CYCLE SETUP

11.1 Why This Module Exists

Before users enter numbers, Finance must define what period is being planned, what model is used, which actual periods are closed, which future periods are forecast, which departments participate, who owns each planning area and when submissions are due.

11.2 Planning Cycle Types

- ANNUAL_BUDGET
- QUARTERLY_FORECAST
- ROLLING_FORECAST
- REFORECAST
- LONG_RANGE_PLAN
- STRATEGIC_PLAN

11.3 Planning Cycle Fields

- Cycle name.
- Planning type.
- Financial year.
- Source model.
- Published model version.
- Actuals cut-off date.
- Forecast start period.
- Planning horizon.
- Base version.
- Base scenario.
- Base currency.
- Submission deadline.
- Workflow.
- Cycle owner.
- Participating entities.
- Participating departments.

11.4 Setup Flow

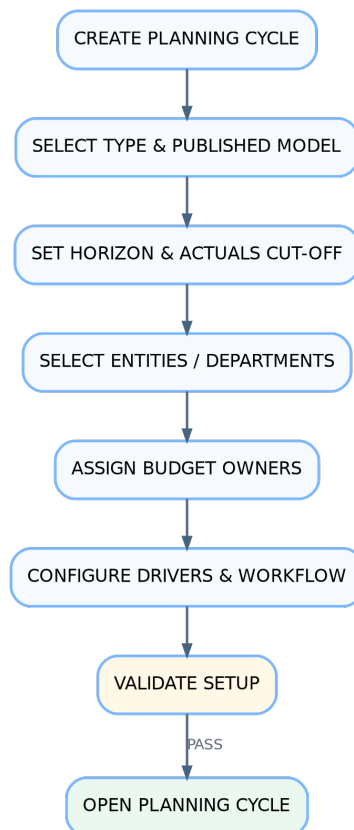


Figure 2: Planning cycle setup and validation flow.

11.5 Validation Before Opening Cycle

The system must verify that the published model is valid, the model period covers the planning horizon, required dimensions and source mappings exist, department owners are assigned, required drivers and workflow stages exist, submission dates are valid and user permissions are present.

Planning cycle cannot be opened.

4 requirements remain:

- Operations Department has no Budget Owner.
- USD/ZiG forecast rate is missing after September 2027.
- Payroll source mapping is invalid.
- CFO approval stage has not been configured.

12. MODULE 3 - PLANNING WORKSHEET

12.1 Purpose

The Planning Worksheet is the primary day-to-day FP&A workspace. It must provide spreadsheet-like data entry without sacrificing system governance.

12.2 Grid Structure

Rows may represent accounts, line items, products, departments, employees or projects. Columns may represent months, quarters, years, versions or scenarios.

Department	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	FY2027
Sales & Marketing	2,154	2,246	2,307	2,415	30,055
Product	1,876	1,924	1,987	2,043	25,453
Engineering	3,245	3,312	3,445	3,568	43,649

12.3 Cell States

ACTUAL
 INPUT
 CALCULATED
 IMPORTED
 LOCKED
 OVERRIDE
 ERROR
 PENDING_CALCULATION

The interface must not rely on colour alone. Use icons, borders, badges, tooltips and cell-detail labels.

12.4 Cell Edit Flow

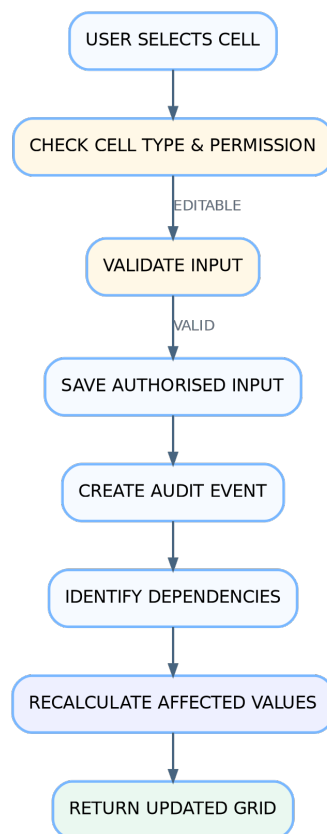


Figure 3: Controlled planning-cell edit and dependency recalculation flow.

12.5 Bulk Editing

- Copy.
- Paste.
- Fill right.
- Fill down.
- Copy prior period.
- Copy prior year.
- Spread annual total.
- Percentage increase.
- Percentage decrease.
- Clear editable values.

All bulk updates must be validated on the server.

12.6 Cell Detail Drawer

CELL DETAILS

Line Item

Revenue

Period

May 2027

Department

Sales

Entity

Arcus Zimbabwe

Version

Forecast Q2

Scenario

Base Case

Value

US\$2,480,000

Status

CALCULATED

Formula

[Units Sold] × [Average Selling Price]

Current Drivers

Units Sold

24,800

Average Selling Price

US\$100

[View Formula Trace]

[View History]

12.7 Planning Worksheet UI

Model Planning

Spreadsheet-style planning with controlled calculations and workflow

Model

FY2027 Corporate

Version

Forecast Q2

Scenario

Base Case

Currency

USD

Compare

Filters

Actions

Account	Jan A	Feb A	Mar A	Apr F	May F	Jun F	Jul F	FY2027
Revenue	9.8	10.2	10.4	10.8	11.2	11.5	11.8	136.2
Cost of Sales	(3.2)	(3.4)	(3.4)	(3.5)	(3.6)	(3.7)	(3.8)	(44.0)
Gross Profit	6.6	6.8	7.0	7.3	7.6	7.8	8.0	92.2
Payroll	(2.1)	(2.1)	(2.2)	(2.3)	(2.4)	(2.5)	(2.5)	(29.3)
Marketing	(0.8)	(0.9)	(0.9)	(1.0)	(1.2)	(1.1)	(1.0)	(12.0)
Other Opex	(0.6)	(0.6)	(0.7)	(0.7)	(0.7)	(0.8)	(0.8)	(8.6)
EBITDA	3.1	3.2	3.2	3.3	3.3	3.4	3.7	42.3
Closing Cash	8.2	8.8	9.4	10.2	11.1	12.3	13.0	14.6

Cell Details

Line Item

Marketing

Period

May 2027

Department

Marketing

Status

INPUT

Value

\$1,200,000

Comment

Q2 campaign launch accelerated.

Revenue vs Expense



Driver Assumptions

Driver	Value	Status
Revenue Growth	8.7%	Approved
USD/ZiG Rate	31.50	Approved
Salary Increase	6.0%	Pending
Closing Headcount	568	Approved

UI Inspiration 2: Model Planning worksheet with editable forecast cells, controlled actuals, calculation detail and driver panels.

13. MODULE 4 - ANNUAL BUDGETING

13.1 Purpose

The annual budget is the formal resource allocation plan. It must determine revenue expectations, cost budgets, headcount, capital expenditure, cash requirements, funding requirements and profitability expectations.

13.2 Budget Workflow

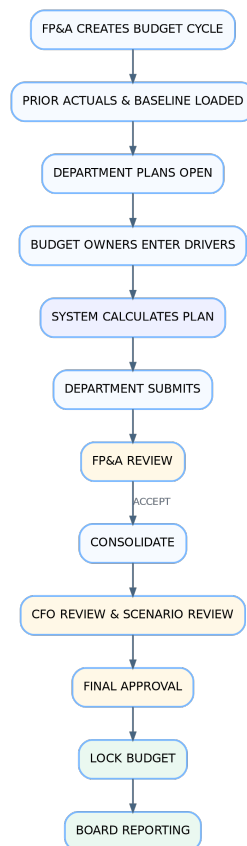


Figure 4: Annual budget workflow from cycle creation to locked budget and Board reporting.

13.3 Budget Baseline Methods

ZERO_BASED
 PRIOR_YEAR_ACTUAL
 PRIOR_YEAR_BUDGET
 LATEST_FORECAST
 DRIVER_BASED
 CUSTOM

Example: Marketing Budget baseline equals FY2026 Actual with 8% growth.

$$\text{Budget}(2027, m) = \text{Actual}(2026, m) \times (1 + \text{Growth Rate})$$

13.4 Budget Owner Workspace

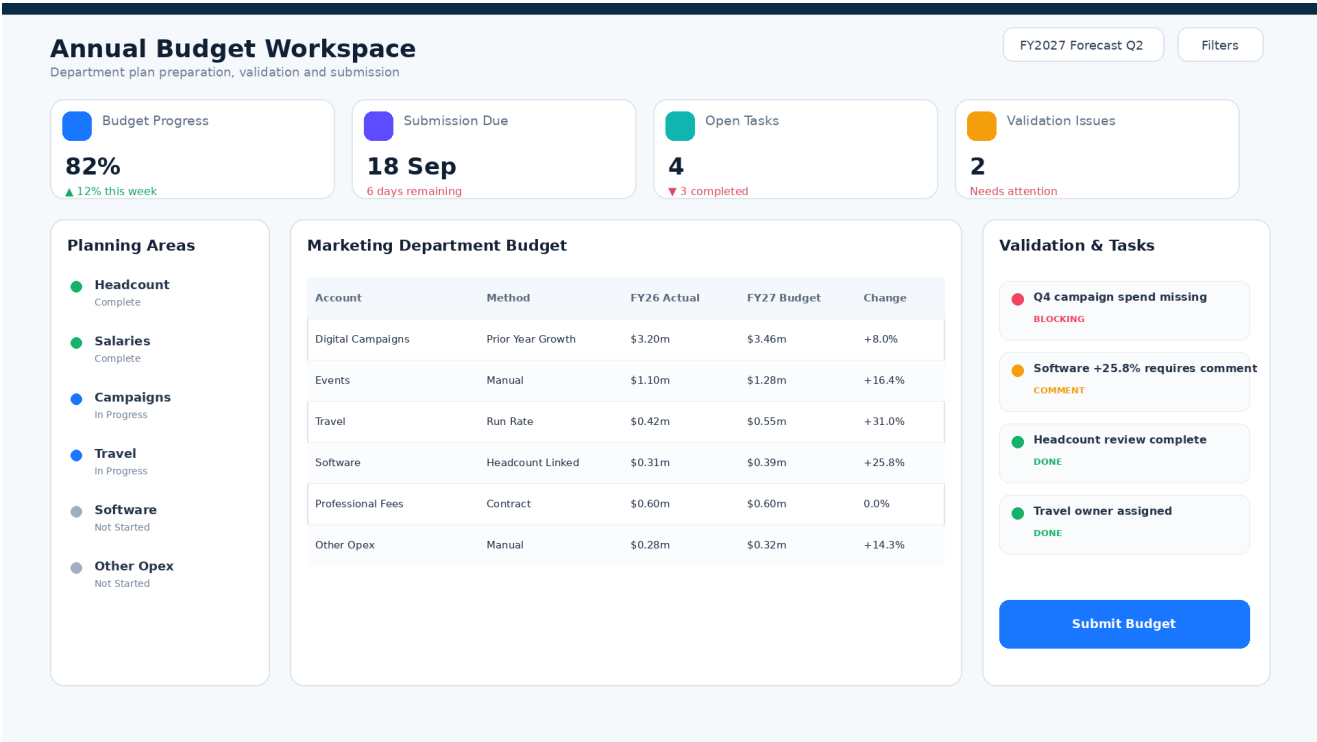
A Department Head must see only the items relevant to their planning responsibility. Do not expose an entire company financial model to every budget owner.

13.5 Submission Controls

```

mandatory_inputs_complete = TRUE
blocking_validation_errors = 0
required_commentary_complete = TRUE
mandatory_tasks_complete = TRUE
budget_owner_assigned = TRUE
  
```

Where a condition is false, submission must be blocked and every unmet requirement must be displayed.



14.2 Forecast Roll Flow

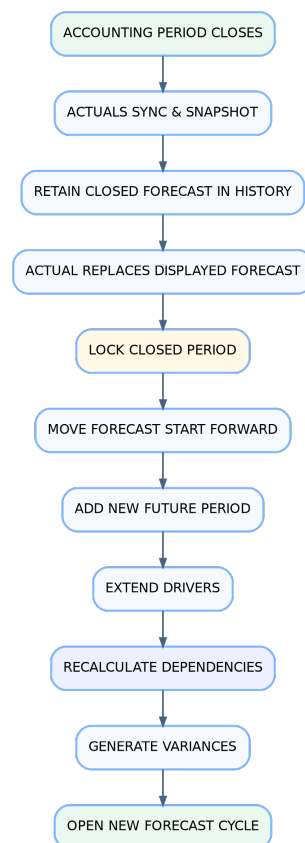


Figure 5: Rolling forecast cut-over from newly closed accounting period to extended future horizon.

14.3 Forecast Methods

MANUAL
 PRIOR_FORECAST_CARRY_FORWARD
 RUN_RATE
 PRIOR_YEAR_GROWTH
 DRIVER_BASED
 SEASONAL
 CONTRACT_SCHEDULE
 PIPELINE_WEIGHTED
 AI_ASSISTED
 CUSTOM_FORMULA

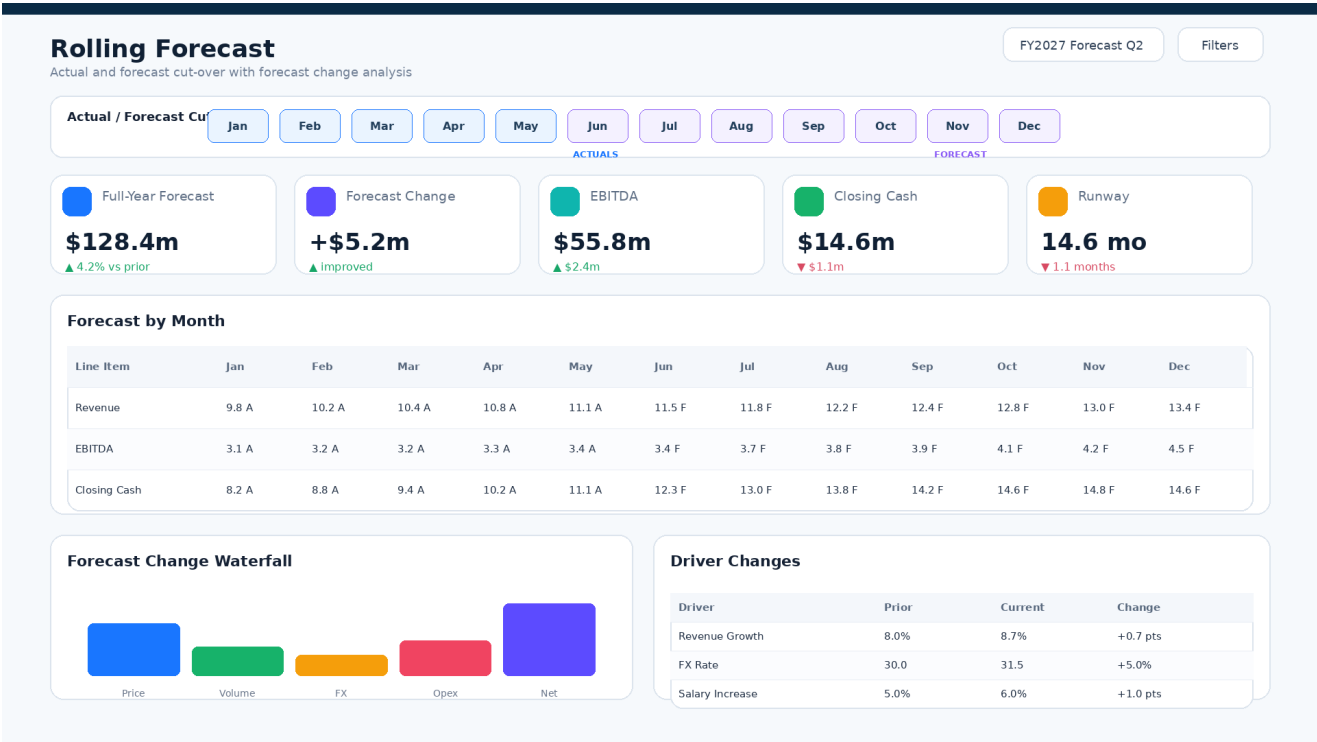
14.4 Run-Rate Forecast

Forecast Expense(t) = Average of Actual(t-1), Actual(t-2) and Actual(t-3)

Weighted run-rate methods must also be supported. Example: 50% prior month + 30% two months prior + 20% three months prior. Weights must be configurable.

14.5 Forecast Versioning

When Forecast Q3 is approved it must be locked. Creating Forecast Q4 must copy Forecast Q3 into a new version, import the latest actuals and open future periods. Forecast Q3 must not be overwritten.



BASE CASE		
Revenue Growth	8.7%	
Salary Increase	6.0%	
Inflation	4.0%	
DOWNSIDE OVERRIDES		
Revenue Growth	-4.0%	
Inflation	7.0%	
EFFECTIVE DOWNSIDE		
Revenue Growth	-4.0%	OVERRIDE
Salary Increase	6.0%	INHERITED
Inflation	7.0%	OVERRIDE

15.4 Scenario Creation Flow

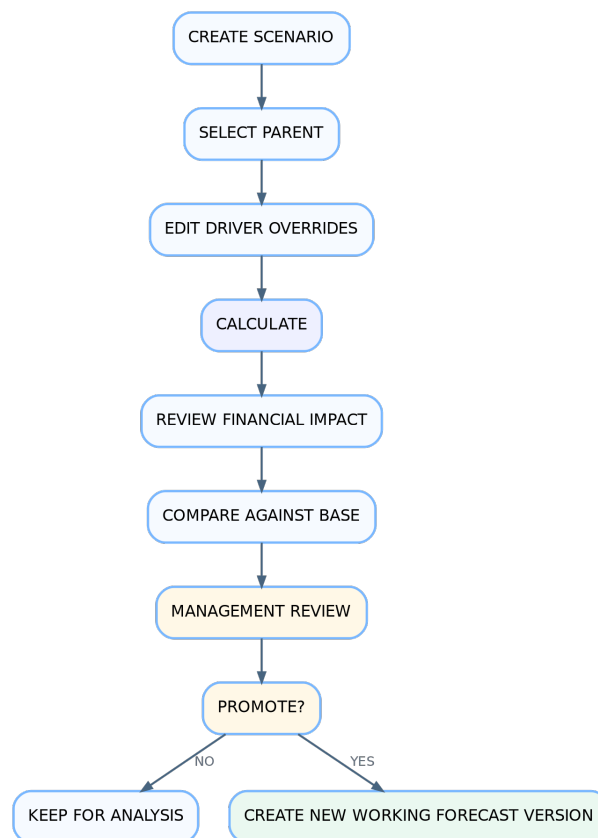
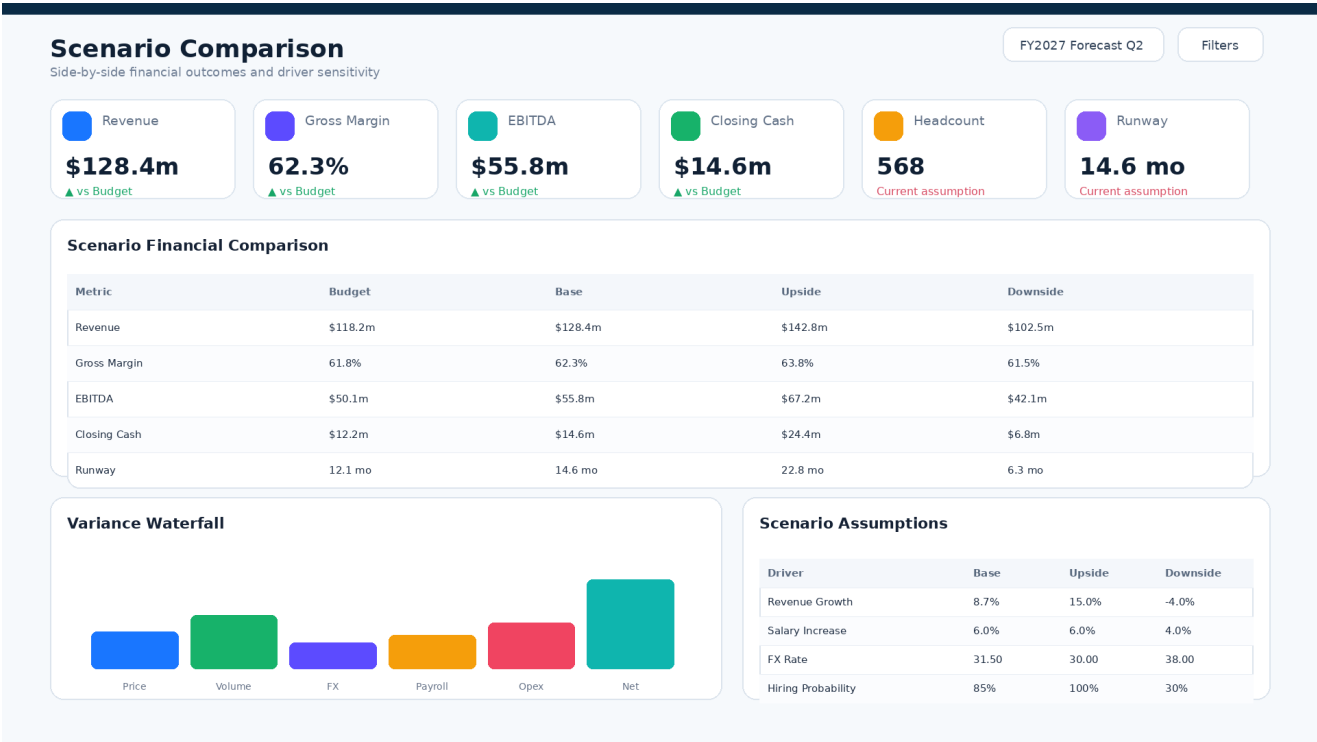


Figure 6: Scenario creation, comparison and controlled promotion to a new working forecast version.

15.5 Promotion Control

Promoting a scenario must never overwrite an approved forecast. Promotion creates a new working forecast version.

15.6 Scenario Comparison UI



UI Inspiration 5: Scenario comparison with budget, Base, Upside and Downside outcomes, waterfall bridge and driver differences.

16. MODULE 7 - ASSUMPTIONS AND DRIVER LIBRARY

16.1 Why This Module Exists

A financial result may be driven by dozens of assumptions. If assumptions are hidden inside formulas, management cannot understand the forecast. The Driver Library makes key assumptions explicit.

16.2 Driver Categories

Category	Example Drivers
Revenue	Volume, price, growth, churn, renewal rate, customer acquisition, deal conversion
Payroll	Headcount, salary, salary increase, bonus, benefits, hiring probability
Expenses	Inflation, rent escalation, travel cost, licence cost per employee
Cash	Collection days, payment days, opening cash
FX	Average rate, closing rate, budget rate
Capex	Asset cost, purchase month, useful life
Funding	Funding date, funding amount, interest rate

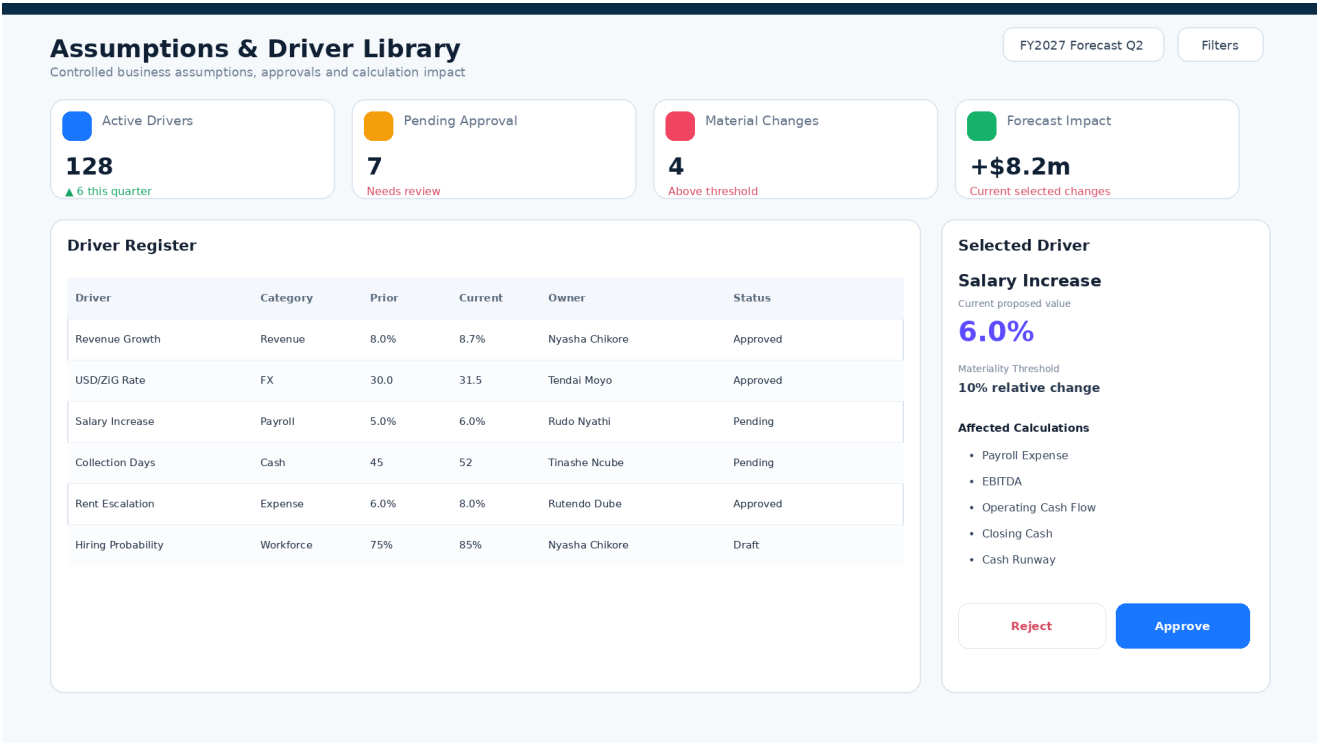
16.3 Driver Record

- Driver name.
- Code.
- Category.
- Description.
- Data type.
- Unit.

- Value.
- Currency.
- Effective period.
- Version.
- Scenario.
- Entity.
- Department where applicable.
- Owner.
- Source.
- Confidence.
- Approval status.
- Materiality classification.
- Commentary.

16.4 Material Driver Approval

Example: USD/ZiG Forecast Rate changes from 28.50 to 36.00, a 26.3% change against a 10% materiality threshold. The system must create an approval request and calculate a preview of the financial impact. The proposed value must not affect the official forecast until approval where configured.



UI Inspiration 6: Driver Library with prior/current values, owners, approval status and affected calculation trace.

17. MODULE 8 - WORKFORCE PLANNING

17.1 Purpose

Workforce planning must connect people decisions to headcount, payroll, benefits, bonuses, employer costs, EBITDA and cash.

17.2 Planning Modes

EMPLOYEE_LEVEL
POSITION_LEVEL
AGGREGATE_HEADCOUNT

Employee level plans named employees. Position level plans a role and number of positions. Aggregate planning manages only departmental headcount totals.

17.3 Workforce Fields

- Employee or Position.
- Department.
- Cost Centre.
- Job title.
- Employment type.
- Start date.
- End date.
- Annual salary.
- Currency.
- Benefits.
- Bonus.
- Employer taxes.
- Allowances.
- Vacancy flag.
- Hiring probability.
- Scenario.

17.4 Headcount Logic

$$\text{ActiveInPeriod} = \text{StartDate} \leq \text{PeriodEnd} \text{ AND } (\text{EndDate is null OR EndDate} \geq \text{PeriodStart})$$

$$\text{Headcount}(t) = \text{Count of Active Employees in period } t$$

17.5 Salary Formula

$$\text{Monthly Salary} = \text{Annual Salary} / 12$$

Where active for part of a month, support FULL_MONTH, DAILY_PRORATION and WORKING_DAY_PRORATION policies.

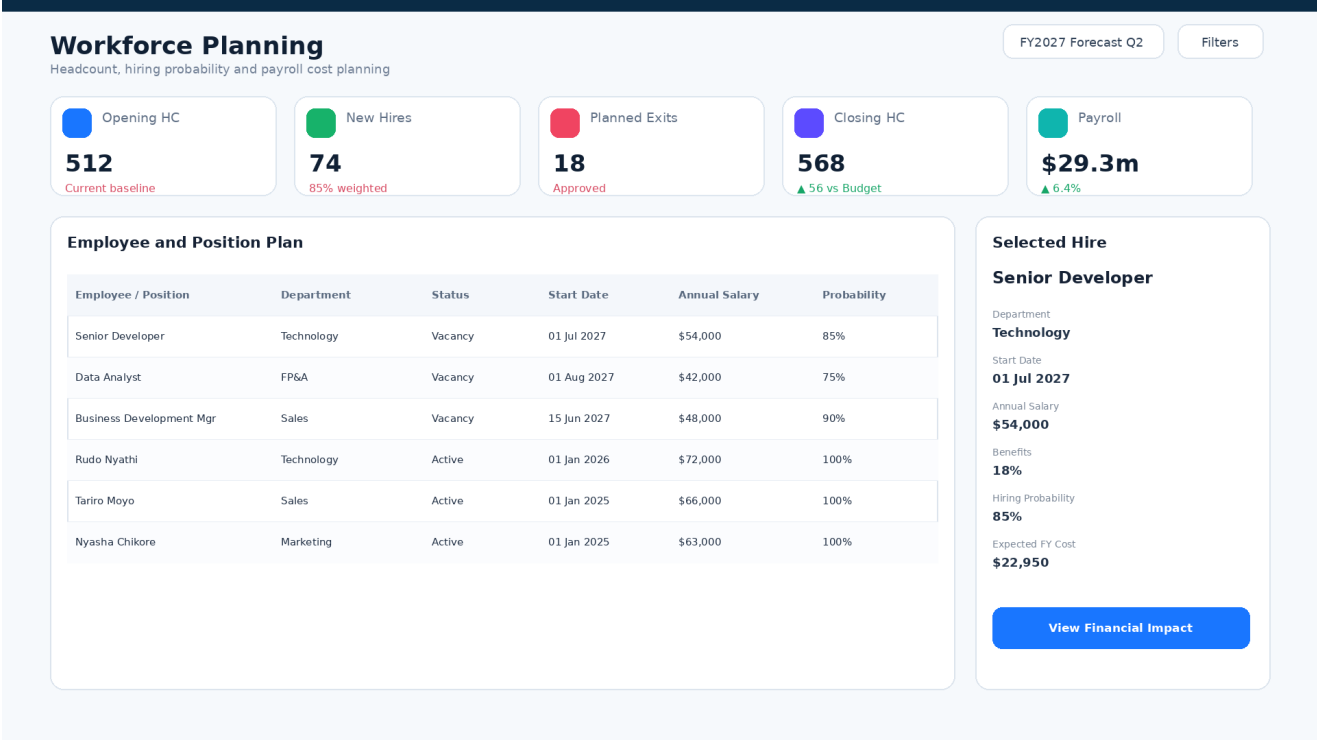
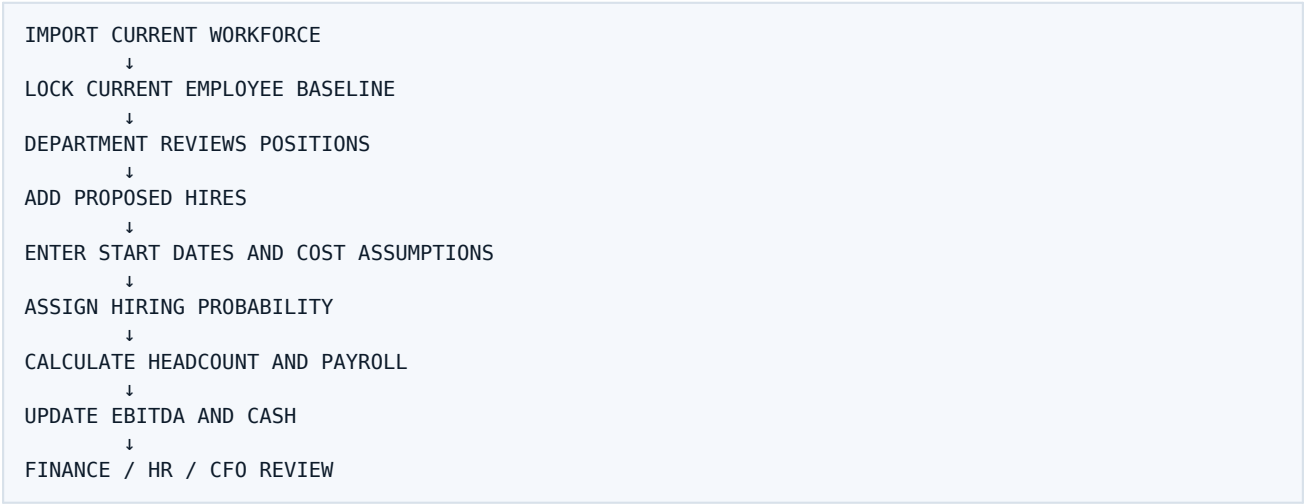
17.6 New Hire Cost

$$\text{Expected New Hire Cost} = \text{Monthly Cost} \times \text{Active Months} \times \text{Hiring Probability}$$

17.7 Total Employee Cost

Total Employee Cost = Salary + Benefits + Bonus + Employer Taxes + Allowances

17.8 Workforce Planning Flow



UI Inspiration 7: Workforce Planning with employee and position register, hiring probability and selected-hire financial impact.

18. MODULE 9 - REVENUE PLANNING

18.1 Purpose

Revenue Planning must model the operational causes of revenue. Do not require every business to use one revenue formula.

18.2 Revenue Planning Methods

MANUAL
UNIT_PRICE
CONTRACT_BASED
SUBSCRIPTION
CUSTOMER_SEGMENT
PIPELINE_WEIGHTED
GROWTH_RATE
TREND
CUSTOM_FORMULA

18.3 Unit-Price Model

$$\text{Revenue} = \text{Units Sold} \times \text{Average Selling Price}$$

18.4 Contract Revenue

$$\text{Monthly Contract Revenue} = \text{Contract Value} / \text{Contract Duration in Months}$$

The system must account for contract start, contract end, renewal, billing frequency and planning revenue-recognition pattern.

18.5 Subscription Revenue

$$\text{Ending Customers}(t) = \text{Opening Customers}(t) + \text{New Customers}(t) - \text{Churned Customers}(t)$$

$$\text{Churned Customers}(t) = \text{Opening Customers}(t) \times \text{Churn Rate}(t)$$

$$\text{MRR}(t) = \text{Active Customers}(t) \times \text{Monthly Subscription Fee}(t)$$

$$\text{ARR} = \text{MRR} \times 12$$

18.6 Pipeline-Weighted Revenue

$$\text{Weighted Revenue}(i) = \text{Expected Deal Value}(i) \times \text{Probability}(i)$$

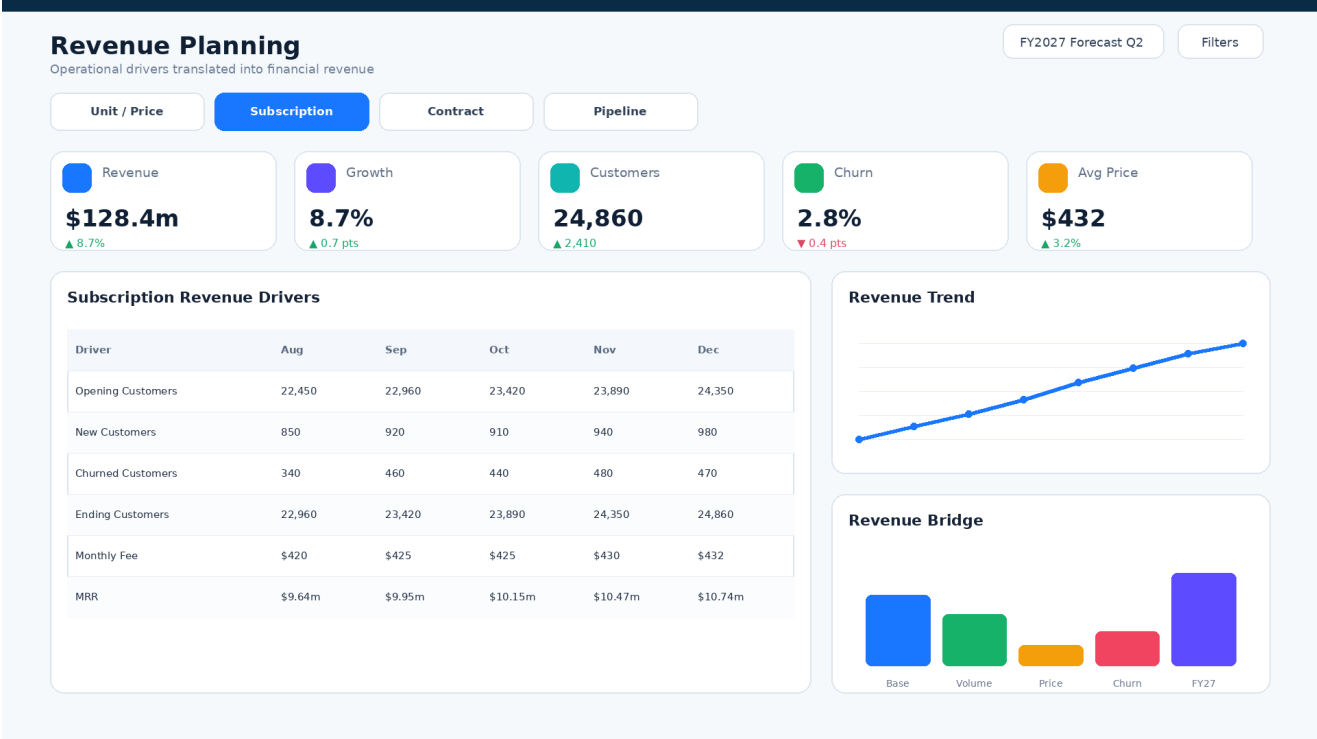
Where CRM or fundraising systems supply probabilities, FP&A must retain source probability, source date and imported value. Finance may apply a controlled adjustment.

18.7 Revenue Planning User Story

As Tendai, an FP&A Analyst, I want to forecast software revenue using customer growth, churn and average subscription price so that revenue automatically changes when these operating assumptions change.

- Opening customers are available.
- New customers may be planned monthly.
- Churn rate is configurable.

- Closing customers calculate automatically.
- MRR recalculates automatically.
- Revenue changes flow to EBITDA and cash.
- Every driver change is retained in history.



Default N is 3 but must be configurable.

19.5 Contract Expense

For a US\$120,000 annual software licence, the basic monthly planning cost is US\$10,000. The system must also support quarterly payment, annual prepayment, contract escalation and start/end dates.

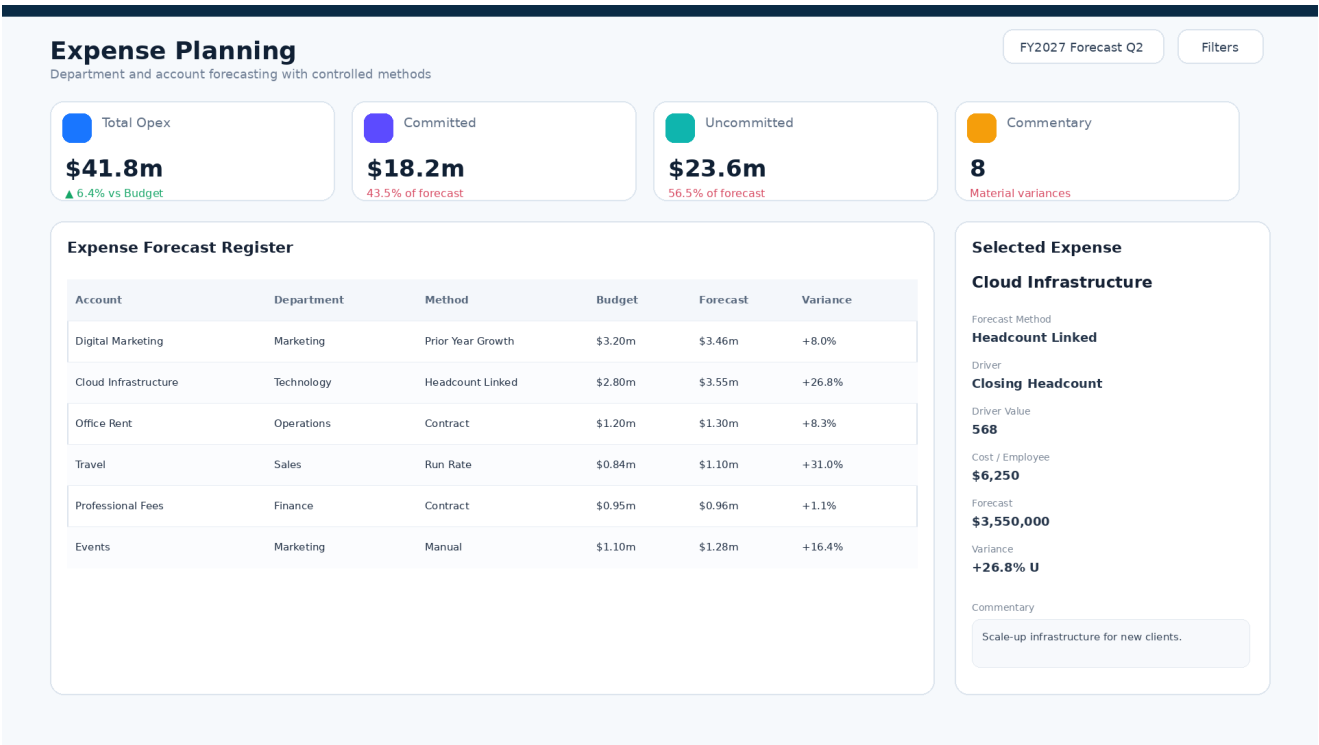
19.6 Headcount-Linked Expense

Software Cost = Headcount x Licence Cost per Employee

If headcount changes from 512 to 568, the software expense must automatically recalculate.

19.7 Procurement-Linked Planning

The module may read approved purchase orders, purchase commitments and contracted supplier values. An unapproved requisition must not be treated as committed expenditure unless configured.



UI Inspiration 9: Expense Planning register with forecast methods, budget/forecast variance and contextual expense driver panel.

20. MODULE 11 - CAPITAL EXPENDITURE PLANNING

20.1 Purpose

Capex planning must connect planned asset purchases to cash, fixed assets, depreciation, profit and loss and the balance sheet.

20.2 Capex Record

- Project.
- Asset category.

- Description.
- Department.
- Purchase month.
- Cost.
- Currency.
- Supplier where known.
- Useful life.
- Depreciation method.
- Approval status.
- Scenario.

20.3 Capex Calculation

$$\text{Cash Outflow}(t) = \text{Purchase Cost}$$

$$\text{Monthly Depreciation} = (\text{Asset Cost} - \text{Residual Value}) / \text{Useful Life in Months}$$

Depreciation start policy must support PURCHASE_MONTH, NEXT_MONTH and IN_SERVICE_DATE.

21. MODULE 12 - WORKING CAPITAL PLANNING

21.1 Purpose

Profit and cash are different. Working capital converts commercial activity into expected cash timing.

21.2 Accounts Receivable

$$\text{Receivables} = \text{Revenue} \times \text{Collection Days} / \text{Days in Period}$$

21.3 Customer Collections

$$\text{Cash Collections} = \text{Opening Receivables} + \text{Revenue} - \text{Closing Receivables}$$

21.4 Accounts Payable

$$\text{Payables} = \text{Eligible Expenses} \times \text{Payment Days} / \text{Days in Period}$$

21.5 Supplier Payments

$$\text{Supplier Payments} = \text{Opening Payables} + \text{Expenses} - \text{Closing Payables}$$

22. MODULE 13 - CASH FLOW PLANNING

22.1 Purpose

The system must show when the organisation may run short of cash.

22.2 Cash Structure

Inflows	Outflows
Customer collections	Payroll
Funding	Suppliers
Loan proceeds	Rent
Asset sales	Tax
Investment distributions	Capex
Interest income	Loan repayments
Other receipts	Dividends / Investment purchases

22.3 Cash Formula

$$\text{Closing Cash}(t) = \text{Opening Cash}(t) + \text{Cash Inflows}(t) - \text{Cash Outflows}(t)$$

$$\text{Opening Cash}(t+1) = \text{Closing Cash}(t)$$

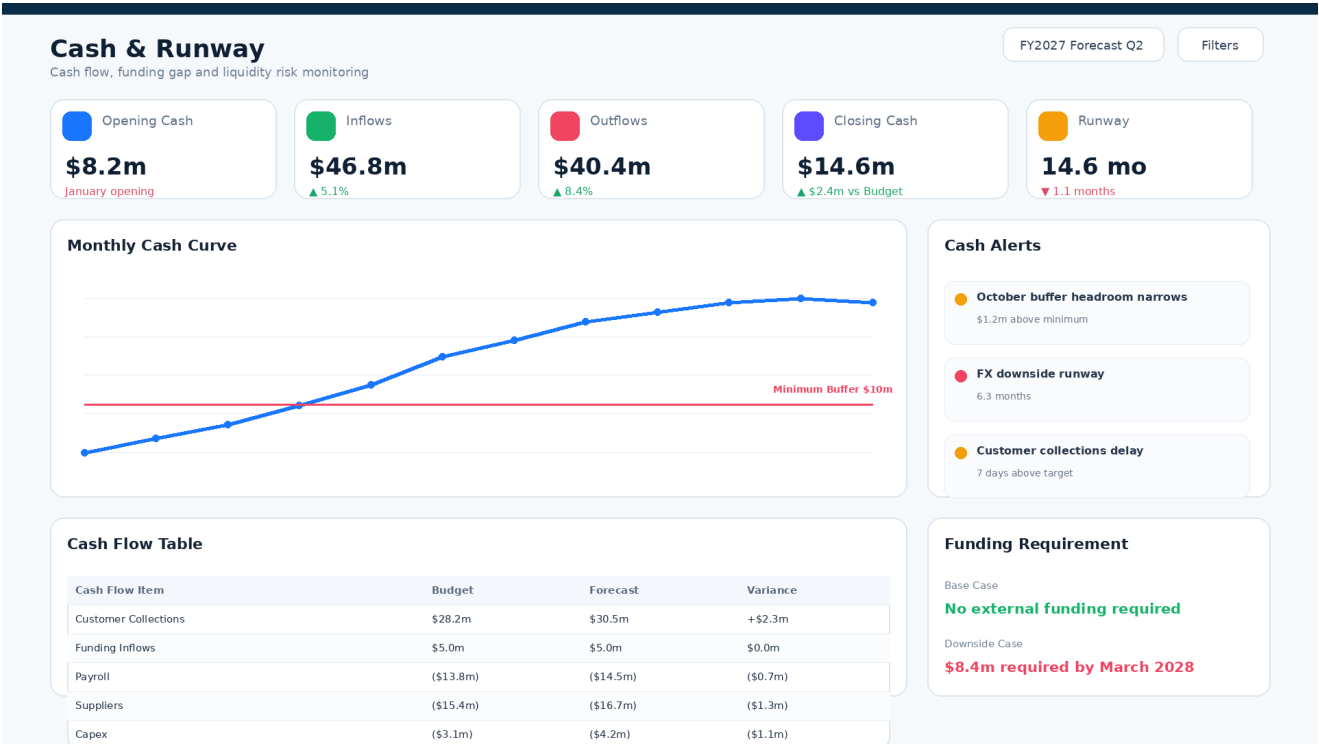
22.4 Cash Runway

$$\text{Cash Runway} = \text{Current Cash} / \text{Average Monthly Net Burn}$$

Where Average Monthly Net Burn is less than or equal to zero, display CASH GENERATIVE. Do not display a negative runway.

22.5 Cash Alert Logic

Cash < Minimum Operating Buffer	→ CASH BUFFER BREACH
Cash Runway < 6 months	→ RUNWAY WATCH
Cash Runway < 3 months	→ CRITICAL CASH RISK

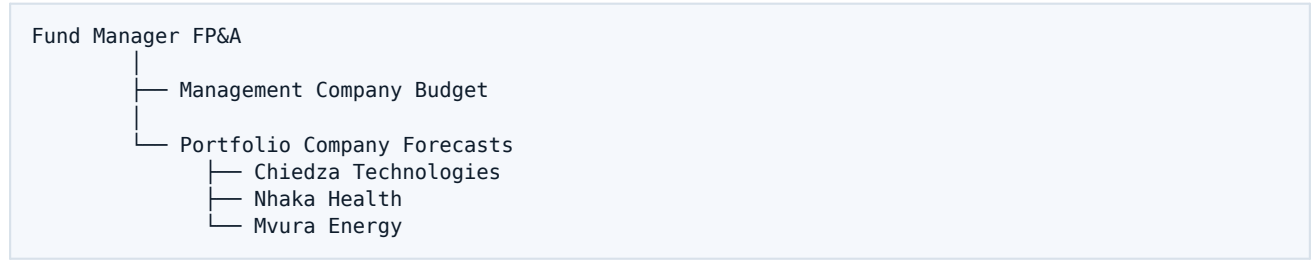


UI Inspiration 10: Cash and Runway workspace with monthly liquidity curve, minimum buffer line, alerts and funding requirement analysis.

23. MODULE 14 - PORTFOLIO COMPANY FORECASTS

23.1 Purpose

For PE and VC organisations using Arcus, FP&A must support financial forecasts for portfolio companies. The fund-level model and portfolio-company model must remain separate.



23.2 Portfolio Company Data

- Revenue.
- EBITDA.
- Cash.
- Headcount.
- Runway.
- Debt.
- Capex.
- Funding needs.

23.3 Portfolio Forecast Submission Flow

```

PORTFOLIO COMPANY REPORTING PERIOD OPENS
↓
COMPANY FORECAST TEMPLATE GENERATED
↓
COMPANY USER ENTERS FORECAST
↓
COMPANY SUBMITS
↓
PORTFOLIO MANAGER REVIEWS
↓
FINANCE VALIDATES
↓
APPROVED FORECAST SNAPSHOT
↓
FP&A IMPORTS APPROVED VALUES
↓
PORTFOLIO DASHBOARD UPDATES
  
```

The system must not automatically accept unreviewed investee forecasts into the official fund planning model.

24. MODULE 15 - ACTUALS INTEGRATION

24.1 Required Sources

Source	Data
Accounting	GL, journals, trial balance
Payroll	Salaries, payroll totals, headcount
Procurement	POs, commitments, supplier spend
Cashbook	Bank balances and cash movements
Fixed Assets	Asset additions and depreciation
Portfolio Management	Portfolio company results
Investment Operations	NAV and valuation data

24.2 Actuals Import Flow

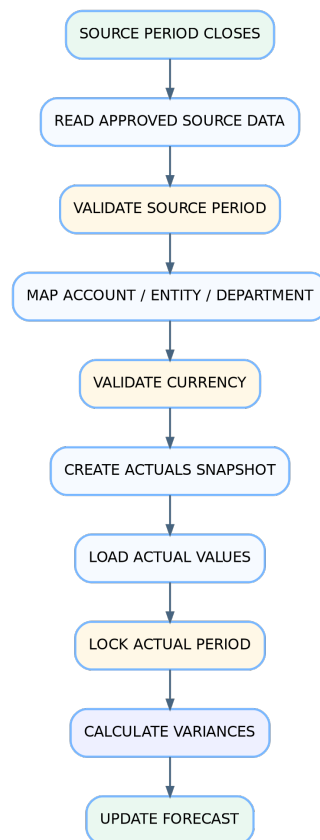


Figure 7: Actuals import, mapping, snapshot and forecast update flow.

24.3 Import Reconciliation

$$\text{Source Total} = \text{Imported Total} + \text{Excluded Total} + \text{Exception Total}$$

Source GL Balance	US\$12,450,000
Mapped	US\$12,430,000
Unmapped	US\$20,000
Difference	US\$0

Where material unmapped values exist, the import must remain PARTIALLY_MAPPED and the official refresh may be blocked.

24.4 Actuals Snapshot

The system must store source, source period, sync date, source closing status, extract checksum, mapping version, imported totals, exception totals, imported by and approved by. This allows historical forecast reproduction.

25. MODULE 16 - VARIANCE ANALYSIS

25.1 Variance Types

```
ACTUAL_VS_BUDGET  
ACTUAL_VS_FORECAST  
FORECAST_VS_BUDGET  
CURRENT_VS_PRIOR_FORECAST  
YTD_ACTUAL_VS_BUDGET  
FULL_YEAR_FORECAST_VS_BUDGET
```

25.2 Absolute Variance

$$\text{Variance} = \text{Actual} - \text{Plan}$$

25.3 Percentage Variance

$$\text{Variance \%} = (\text{Actual} - \text{Plan}) / \text{ABS}(\text{Plan}) \times 100$$

Where Plan equals zero, display N/A and optionally show NEW SPEND or NEW REVENUE.

25.4 Variance Direction

Each line item must define HIGHER_IS_FAVOURABLE, LOWER_IS_FAVOURABLE or NEUTRAL. Revenue above budget may be favourable, while expense above budget is normally unfavourable.

25.5 FX Variance

$$\text{Currency Variance} = \text{Transaction Amount} \times (\text{Actual FX} - \text{Forecast FX})$$

Operational variance must compare values using the same FX basis. This is critical for a multi-currency Zimbabwean operating environment.

25.6 Variance Commentary Workflow

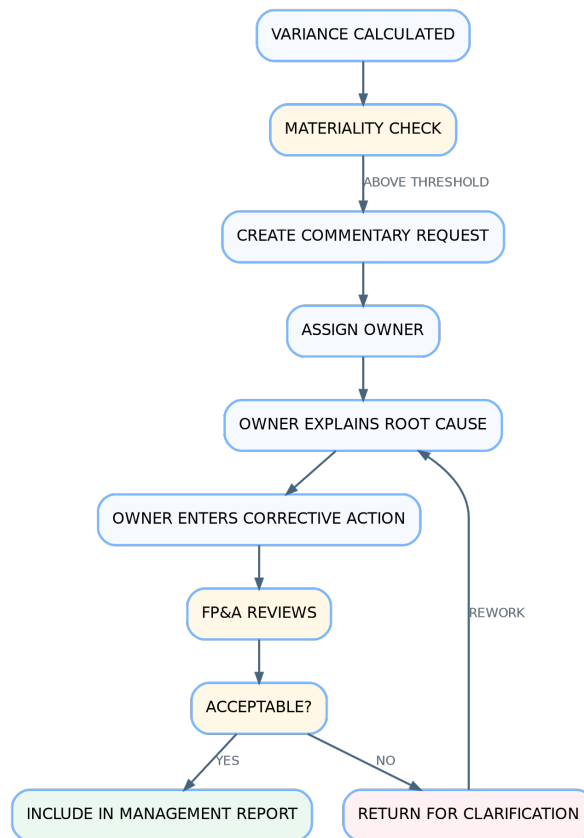


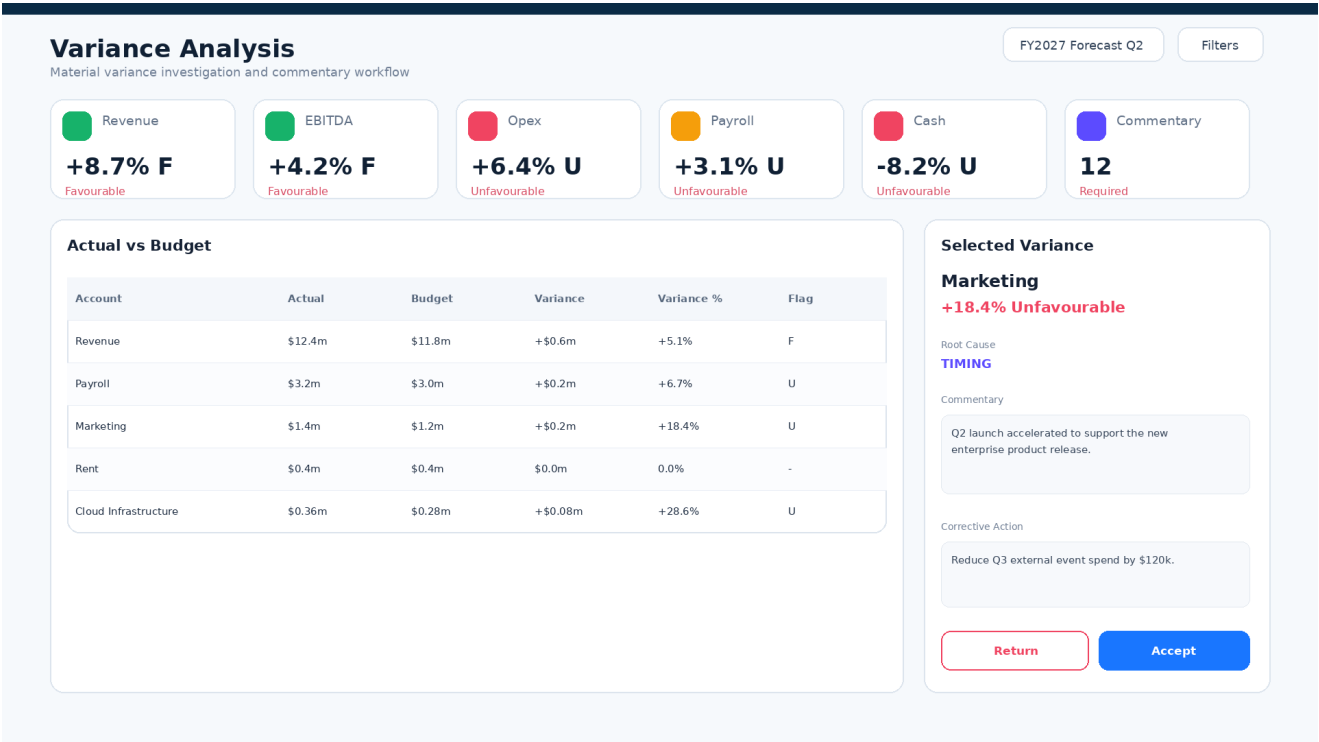
Figure 8: Material variance commentary, corrective action and FP&A; review workflow.

25.7 Commentary Record

- Variance.
- Line item.
- Department.
- Owner.
- Explanation.
- Root cause category.
- Corrective action.
- Forecast impact.
- Due date.
- Reviewer.
- Status.

Root-cause categories must include PRICE, VOLUME, MIX, TIMING, FX, HEADCOUNT, INFLATION, ONE_OFF, OPERATIONAL, ACCOUNTING and OTHER.

25.8 Variance Workspace Wireframe



26.3 Maker-Checker

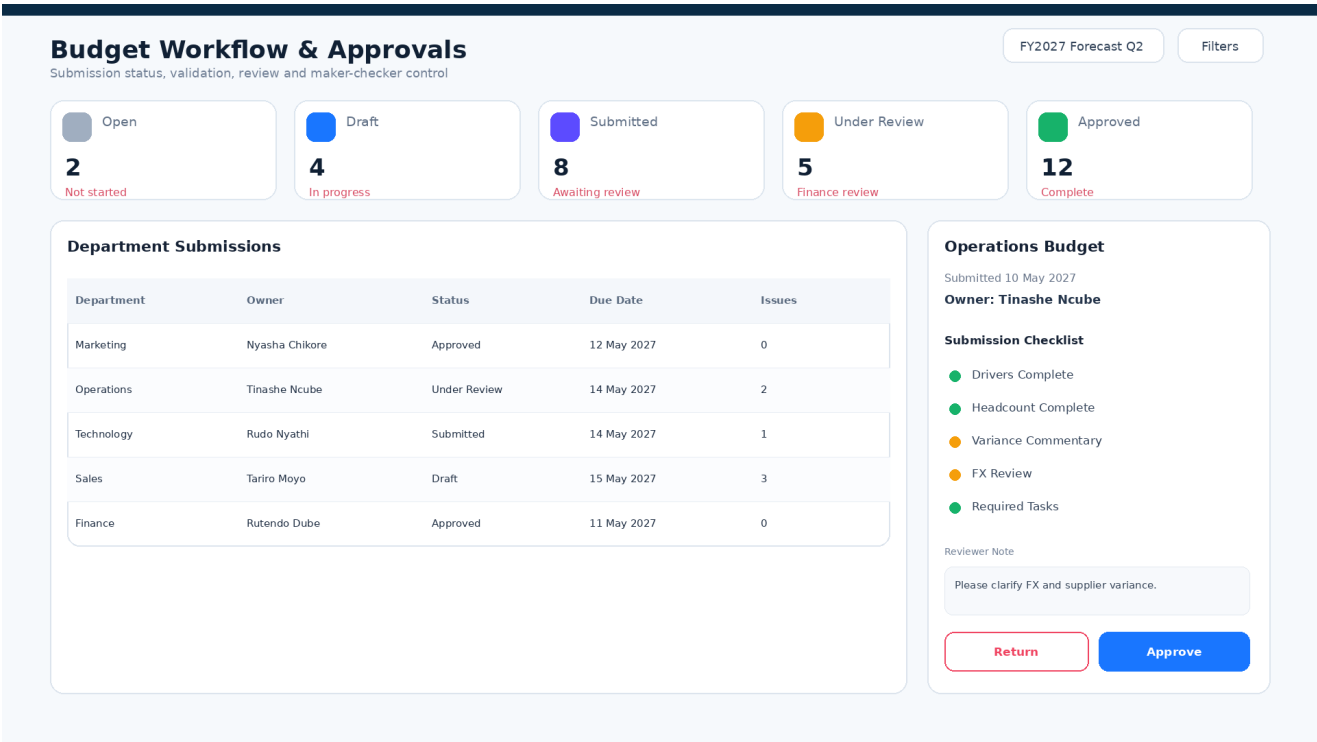
submitted_by != approved_by

The API must enforce maker-checker. Frontend controls alone are insufficient.

26.4 Workflow Workspace

Required sections include cycle progress, department status, task queue, submission register, approval history, due-date risks and a selected-submission inspector.

26.5 Workflow Wireframe



UI Inspiration 11: Workflow and Approvals workspace with department submissions, validation checklist and review actions.

27. MODULE 18 - MANAGEMENT REPORTING

Reports must use an identified Model, Version, Scenario, Actuals Snapshot and Report Date. Required reports include P&L Forecast, Balance Sheet Forecast, Cash Flow Forecast, Budget Summary, Forecast Summary, Department Budget, Headcount Plan, Revenue Plan, Opex Plan, Capex Plan, Cash Runway, Scenario Comparison, Variance Report and Management Commentary Report.

Reports must not silently switch to a newer forecast.

28. MODULE 19 - BOARD PACKS

28.1 Purpose

Board packs must be generated from approved data. Required contents may include executive financial summary, revenue, EBITDA, cash, runway, full-year forecast, scenario risks, budget variance, forecast variance, department risks, management commentary and key assumptions.

28.2 Board Pack Generation Flow

```
graph TD; A[USER SELECTS APPROVED VERSION] --> B[SYSTEM VALIDATES LOCK STATUS]; B --> C[SELECT REPORT TEMPLATE]; C --> D[CREATE REPORTING SNAPSHOT]; D --> E[CALCULATE REPORT METRICS]; E --> F[PULL APPROVED COMMENTARY]; F --> G[GENERATE DRAFT PACK]; G --> H[FINANCE REVIEW]; H --> I[CFO APPROVAL]; I --> J[GENERATE FINAL PDF]; J --> K[ARCHIVE REPORT];
```

29. MODULE 20 - AI-ASSISTED FORECASTING

AI is an assistant. It must not become the authoritative planning engine.

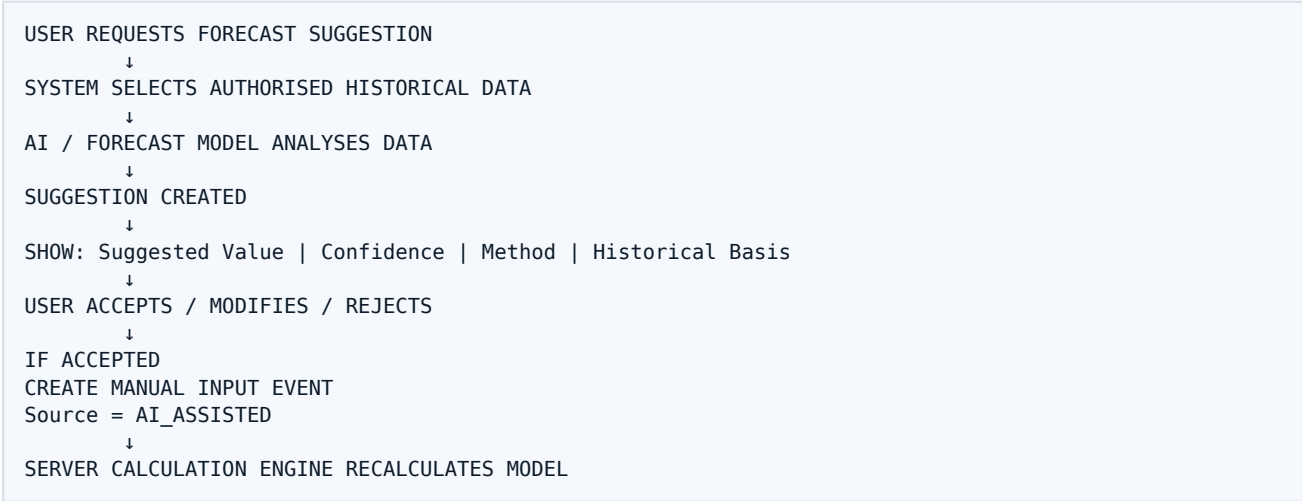
29.1 Permitted AI Functions

- Forecast suggestions.
- Anomaly detection.
- Trend-break identification.
- Draft variance commentary.
- Cash-shortfall alerts.
- Scenario suggestions.
- Forecast confidence assessment.

29.2 Prohibited AI Actions

- Approve a budget.
- Lock a forecast.
- Overwrite actuals.
- Change Accounting.
- Approve a driver.
- Submit a Board report.
- Replace CFO approval.

29.3 Forecast Suggestion Flow

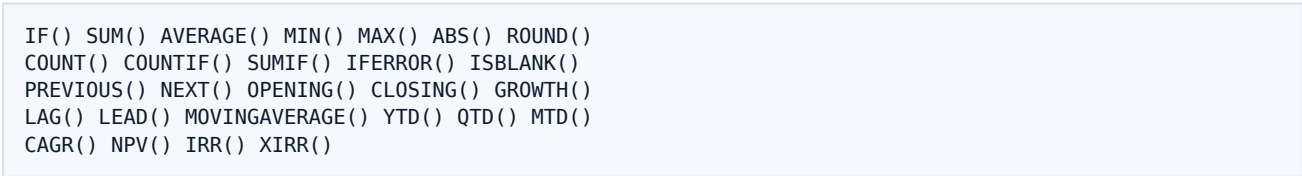


Do not write an AI suggestion directly into an approved forecast.

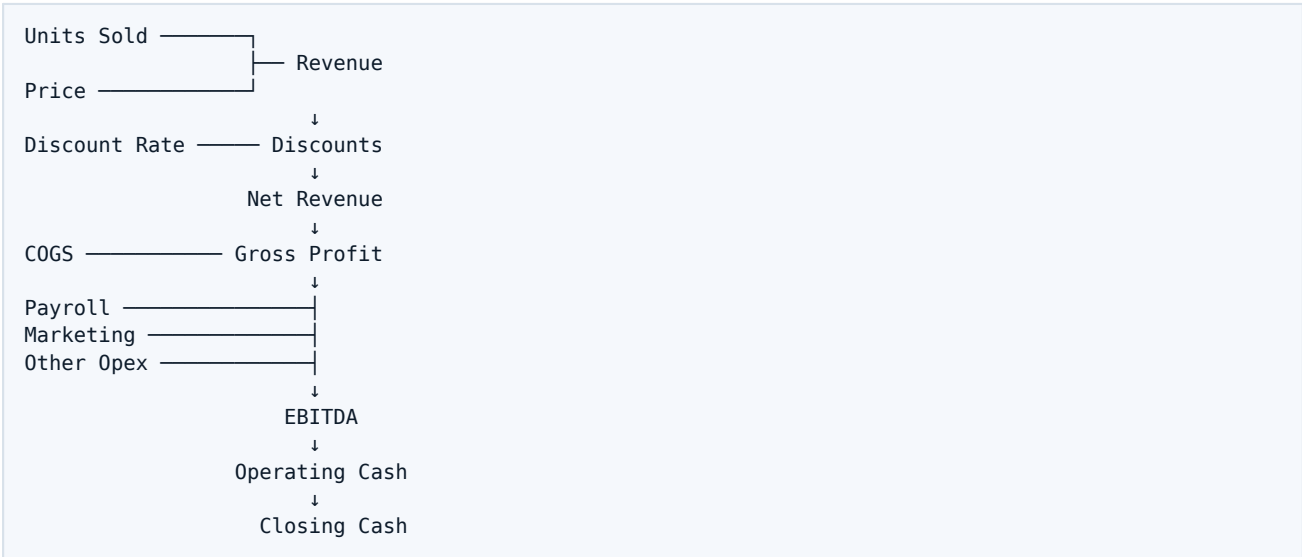
30. CALCULATION ENGINE REQUIREMENTS

The calculation engine must parse formulas, resolve dependencies, detect circular references, calculate time references, aggregate dimensions, calculate allocations, calculate scenario overlays, translate currencies, identify downstream cells, recalculate affected cells and record errors.

30.1 Required Functions



30.2 Dependency Graph



30.3 Directed Recalculation

When Price changes, recalculate Revenue, Discount, Net Revenue, Gross Profit, EBITDA, Cash Flow, Closing Cash and Runway. Do not recalculate an unrelated Employee Benefits Model unless it depends on the changed value.

31. VERSION AND LOCKING LOGIC

31.1 Version States

```
DRAFT
WORKING
SUBMITTED
UNDER_REVIEW
APPROVED
LOCKED
ARCHIVED
```

31.2 Locked Version Rule

Where version.status = LOCKED, all write APIs must reject changes. Attempted changes must be audit logged.

```
{
  "status": "LOCKED_VERSION",
  "message": "FY2027 Board Approved Budget is locked and cannot be amended."
}
```

31.3 Reopening an Approved Version

Do not unlock silently. A reopen request must capture a reason and require approval. Creating a new working copy should be the default. Reopening the existing version should only occur where policy explicitly permits it.

32. CONCURRENCY CONTROL

Several users may edit a plan at the same time. Use optimistic concurrency and a record_version value.

```
User A loads record_version = 15
User B loads record_version = 15

User A saves
record_version = 16

User B tries to save version 15

409 CONFLICT
This value changed after you opened the worksheet.
Current Value: US$120,000
Changed By: Nyasha Chikore
Changed At: 14:32

[Reload] [Compare]
```

Do not silently overwrite User A.

33. DATABASE ARCHITECTURE

Required core tables:

```
fpa_models
fpa_model_versions
fpa_modules
fpa_dimensions
fpa_dimension_members
fpa_line_items
fpa_formula_definitions
fpa_formula_dependencies

fpa_planning_cycles
fpa_plan_versions
fpa_scenarios
fpa_scenario_overrides

fpa_planning_values
fpa_actual_values
fpa_calculation_cache
fpa_calculation_jobs

fpa_drivers
fpa_driver_values
fpa_driver_approvals

fpa_workforce_plan_items
fpa_revenue_plan_items
fpa_expense_plan_items
fpa_capex_plan_items
fpa_working_capital_assumptions
fpa_cash_plan_items

fpa_actuals_snapshots
fpa_import_jobs
fpa_import_exceptions
fpa_data_mappings

fpa_variance_results
fpa_variance_commentary

fpa_workflow_instances
fpa_workflow_steps
fpa_workflow_actions
fpa_planning_tasks

fpa_comments
fpa_approvals
fpa_locks

fpa_report_runs
fpa_board_pack_runs

fpa_ai_forecast_suggestions
fpa_audit_logs
```

34. REPRESENTATIVE PLANNING VALUE TABLE

```
CREATE TABLE fpa_planning_values (
  planning_value_id UUID PRIMARY KEY DEFAULT gen_random_uuid(),

  planning_cycle_id UUID NOT NULL,
  plan_version_id UUID NOT NULL,
  scenario_id UUID NOT NULL,
  line_item_id UUID NOT NULL,
  period_id UUID NOT NULL,

  dimension_intersection JSONB NOT NULL,

  numeric_value NUMERIC(30,10),
  text_value TEXT,
  boolean_value BOOLEAN,

  value_source VARCHAR(50) NOT NULL,
  cell_status VARCHAR(50) NOT NULL,

  formula_id UUID,
  driver_value_id UUID,

  entered_by UUID,
  entered_at TIMESTAMPTZ,

  record_version BIGINT NOT NULL DEFAULT 1,

  created_at TIMESTAMPTZ DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP,
  updated_at TIMESTAMPTZ DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP
);
```

Recommended value_source values: ACTUAL, MANUAL_INPUT, FORMULA, DRIVER, SCENARIO_OVERRIDE, IMPORT, ALLOCATION and AI_ASSISTED.

35. API REQUIREMENTS

Planning Cycles

```
POST    /api/v1/fpa/planning-cycles
GET     /api/v1/fpa/planning-cycles
GET     /api/v1/fpa/planning-cycles/{cycle_id}
PATCH  /api/v1/fpa/planning-cycles/{cycle_id}
POST    /api/v1/fpa/planning-cycles/{cycle_id}/validate
POST    /api/v1/fpa/planning-cycles/{cycle_id}/open
POST    /api/v1/fpa/planning-cycles/{cycle_id}/close
```

Planning Grid

```
GET     /api/v1/fpa/planning/{cycle_id}/grid
POST    /api/v1/fpa/planning/{cycle_id}/values
POST    /api/v1/fpa/planning/{cycle_id}/bulk-values
POST    /api/v1/fpa/planning/{cycle_id}/spread
POST    /api/v1/fpa/planning/{cycle_id}/copy-forward
GET     /api/v1/fpa/planning-values/{value_id}/history
GET     /api/v1/fpa/planning-values/{value_id}/trace
```

Calculation

```
POST    /api/v1/fpa/planning/{cycle_id}/calculate
GET     /api/v1/fpa/calculation-jobs/{job_id}
GET     /api/v1/fpa/calculation-jobs/{job_id}/errors
```

Drivers

```
POST    /api/v1/fpa/drivers
GET     /api/v1/fpa/drivers
POST    /api/v1/fpa/drivers/{driver_id}/values
GET     /api/v1/fpa/drivers/{driver_id}/history
POST    /api/v1/fpa/driver-values/{value_id}/submit
POST    /api/v1/fpa/driver-values/{value_id}/approve
```

Scenarios

```
POST    /api/v1/fpa/scenarios
GET     /api/v1/fpa/scenarios
POST    /api/v1/fpa/scenarios/{scenario_id}/copy
POST    /api/v1/fpa/scenarios/{scenario_id}/override
POST    /api/v1/fpa/scenarios/{scenario_id}/calculate
GET     /api/v1/fpa/scenarios/compare
POST    /api/v1/fpa/scenarios/{scenario_id}/promote
```

Actuals

```
POST    /api/v1/fpa/actuals/sync
GET     /api/v1/fpa/actuals/snapshots
GET     /api/v1/fpa/actuals/imports/{job_id}
GET     /api/v1/fpa/actuals/imports/{job_id}/exceptions
POST    /api/v1/fpa/actuals/imports/{job_id}/approve
```

Variances

```
POST    /api/v1/fpa/variance/calculate
GET     /api/v1/fpa/variance/results
GET     /api/v1/fpa/variance/{variance_id}
POST    /api/v1/fpa/variance/{variance_id}/commentary
POST    /api/v1/fpa/variance/{variance_id}/accept-commentary
POST    /api/v1/fpa/variance/{variance_id}/return-commentary
```

Workflow

```
GET     /api/v1/fpa/tasks/my-tasks
POST    /api/v1/fpa/plans/{plan_id}/submit
POST    /api/v1/fpa/plans/{plan_id}/return
POST    /api/v1/fpa/plans/{plan_id}/approve
POST    /api/v1/fpa/versions/{version_id}/lock
POST    /api/v1/fpa/versions/{version_id}/request-reopen
```

36. EVENT ARCHITECTURE

Recommended events:

FPA_PLANNING_CYCLE_OPENED
FPA_VALUE_CHANGED
FPA_DRIVER_CHANGED
FPA_DRIVER_APPROVED
FPA_CALCULATION_COMPLETED
FPA_CALCULATION_FAILED
FPA_ACTUALS_IMPORTED
FPA_ACTUALS_LOCKED
FPA_FORECAST_ROLLED
FPA_VARIANCE_MATERIAL
FPA_COMMENTARY_REQUESTED
FPA_PLAN_SUBMITTED
FPA_PLAN_RETURNED
FPA_PLAN_APPROVED
FPA_VERSION_LOCKED
FPA_SCENARIO_PROMOTED
FPA_BOARD_PACK_APPROVED

Consumers must process events idempotently.

37. SECURITY

Permissions must be enforceable at module, model, model version, planning cycle, scenario, entity, department, cost centre, line item and dimension-member level.

User: Nyasha Chikore
READ Total Company Summary
WRITE Marketing Department
NO ACCESS Individual Executive Salaries

User: Zambia Regional Manager
WRITE Zambia
READ Consolidated Group
NO ACCESS Zimbabwe Detailed Department Plans

Security must be enforced in the API. Do not rely on hidden frontend components.

38. PERFORMANCE REQUIREMENTS

Function	Target
Standard planning grid	< 3 seconds
Cell edit acknowledgement	< 1 second
Small dependency calculation	< 2 seconds
Dashboard	< 3 seconds
Scenario comparison	< 5 seconds for normal model
Large model calculation	Asynchronous
Actual import	Background job
Board pack generation	Background job

Recommended architecture: sparse value storage, dependency-directed calculation, calculation caching, indexed dimension intersections, bulk writes, asynchronous jobs and columnar analytical cache where justified.

39. DEVELOPER GUARDRAILS

Developers must never:

- Treat actuals and forecasts as the same record.
- Overwrite an approved budget.
- Trust calculated values submitted by the browser.
- Allow users to edit calculated cells.
- Hide driver changes inside formula text.
- Recalculate an approved plan using a new formula without controlled migration.
- Overwrite prior forecast versions.
- Allow a user to approve their own submission where maker-checker applies.
- Allow scenario analysis to change the official forecast automatically.
- Write AI suggestions directly into approved plans.
- Count locked actual periods as editable forecasts.
- Silently resolve concurrent edits by accepting the last request.
- Calculate favourable or unfavourable variance using numeric sign alone.
- Treat a cash-generative business as having negative runway.
- Accept material unmapped actuals without configured approval.

40. ADDITIONAL USER STORIES

40.1 Annual Budget

As Rutendo, the FP&A Manager, I want to open the FY2028 budget cycle and assign each department its planning responsibilities so that the company can prepare one controlled budget.

- Published model selected.
- Prior actuals loaded.
- Budget owners assigned.
- Tasks created.
- Department permissions applied.
- Submission deadlines visible.

40.2 Department Budget Submission

As Nyasha, the Marketing Director, I want to enter campaign, headcount and travel assumptions so that Finance can calculate my full departmental budget.

- Nyasha sees Marketing only.
- Inputs are editable.
- Formulas are read-only.
- Payroll impacts calculate.
- Comments may be added.
- Submission validation runs.

40.3 Rolling Forecast

As Tendai, an FP&A Analyst, I want June actuals to replace June forecast and extend the forecast by one future month so that management always has an 18-month outlook.

- June forecast retained in history.
- June actual loaded.
- June becomes read-only.
- Horizon extends.
- Future drivers remain.
- Downstream values recalculate.

40.4 Scenario Comparison

As the CFO, I want to compare Base, Downside and FX Shock scenarios so that I understand the impact on EBITDA and cash runway.

- Scenarios appear side by side.
- Changed drivers are visible.
- Financial results calculate independently.
- Variance to Base is shown.
- User can trace result to driver.

40.5 Material Variance

As Tinashe, Head of Operations, I want to explain why supplier expenses are 18% above budget so that management understands the cause and corrective action.

- Commentary task created automatically.
- Variance detail available.
- Explanation mandatory.
- Corrective action mandatory where configured.
- FP&A can accept or return commentary.

40.6 Trace Cash Runway

As an FP&A Analyst, I want to trace the cash-runway calculation so that I can explain why runway fell from 14.6 months to 9.2 months.

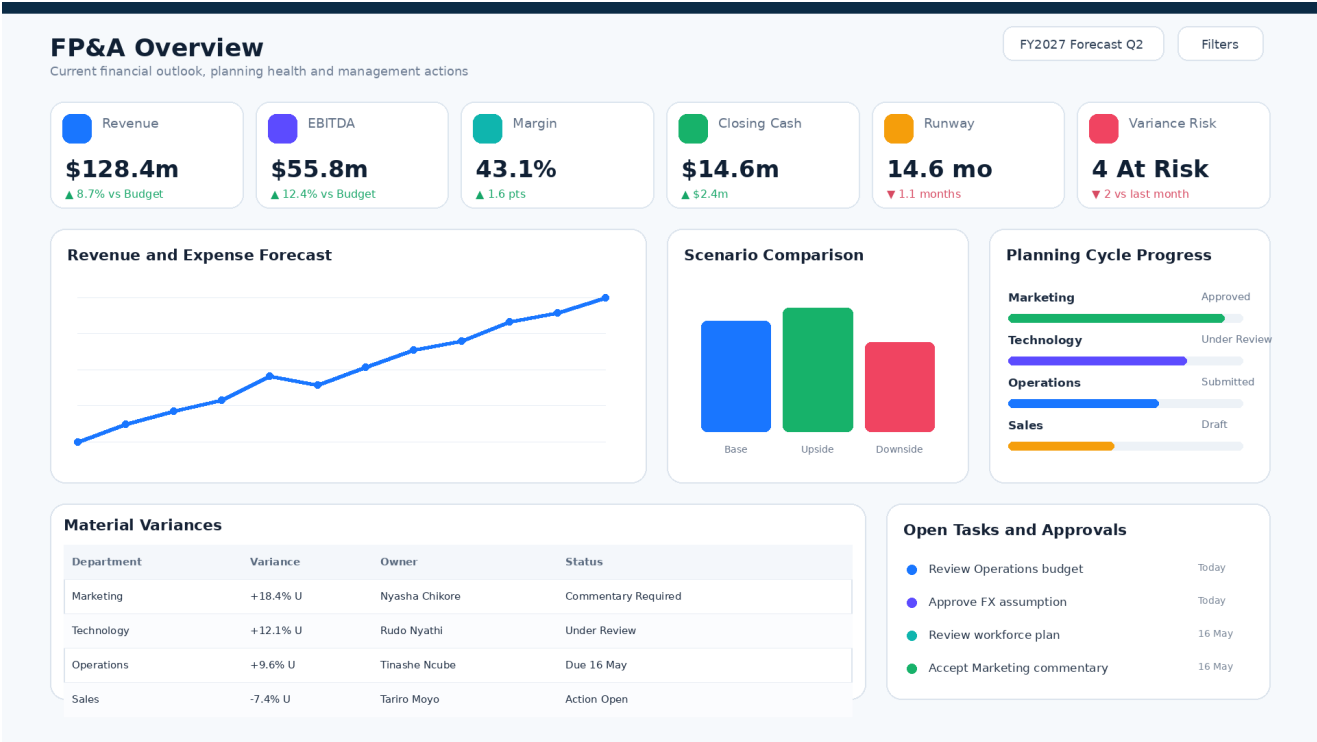
- Current cash displayed.
- Burn-period calculation shown.
- Source cash values shown.
- Forecast outflow changes shown.
- Affected drivers accessible.

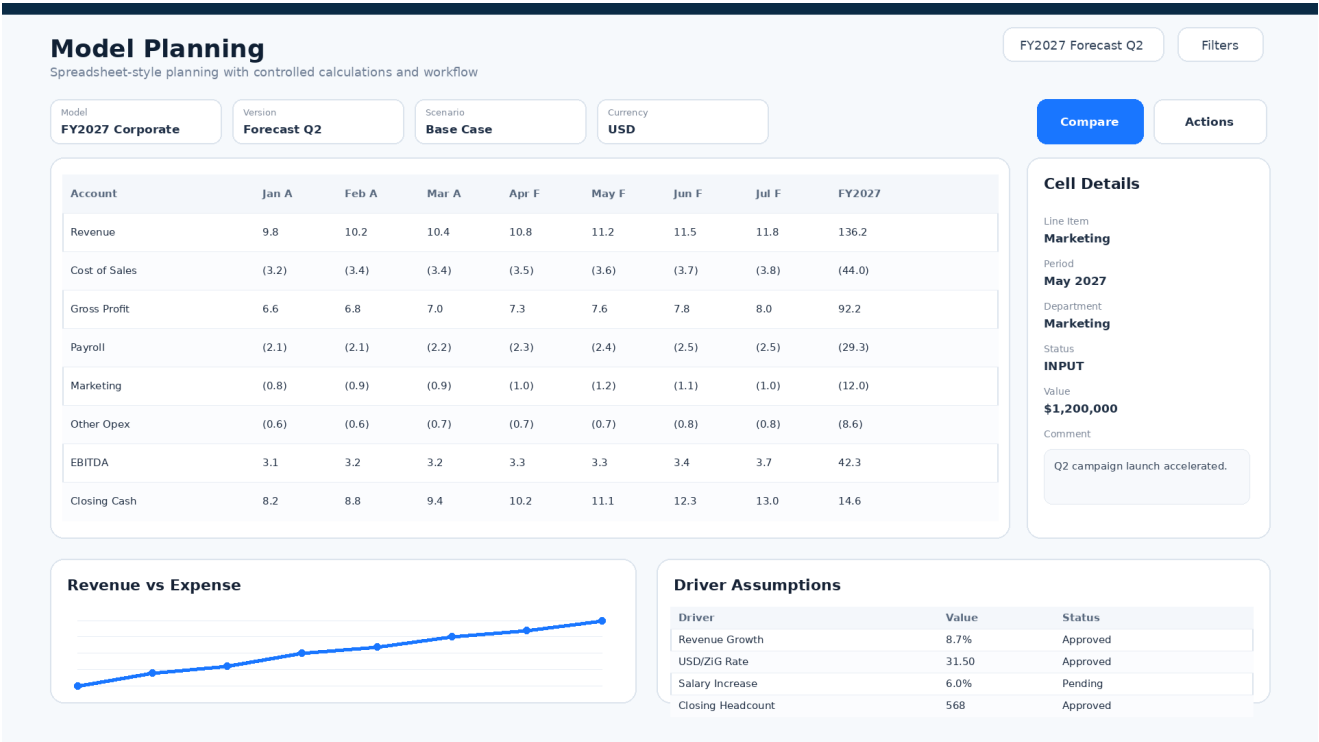
41. COMPLETE UI INSPIRATION SCREEN MAP

The UI design system must use a white main canvas, soft cool-grey page background, deep navy text, vibrant cobalt blue, electric indigo, violet, teal and emerald accents, fine grey borders and subtle shadows. The interface should feel like a high-end financial application designed for a modern macOS workstation rather than a generic administration dashboard.

Primary validation viewport: 1440 x 900 minimum, 1536 x 960 preferred and 1920 x 1200 for high-resolution UI reference generation. Validate the main workflows on a 13.5-inch laptop at normal browser scale.

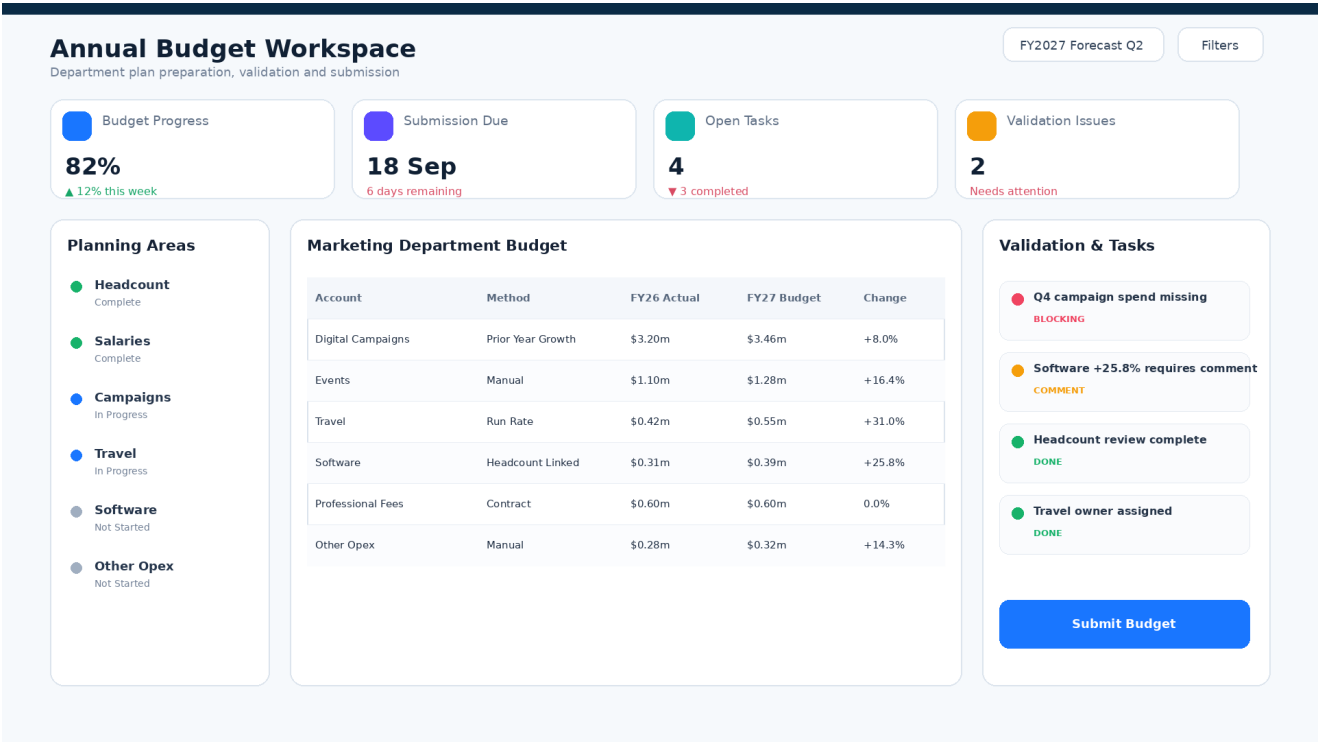
UI 1 - FP&A; Executive Home





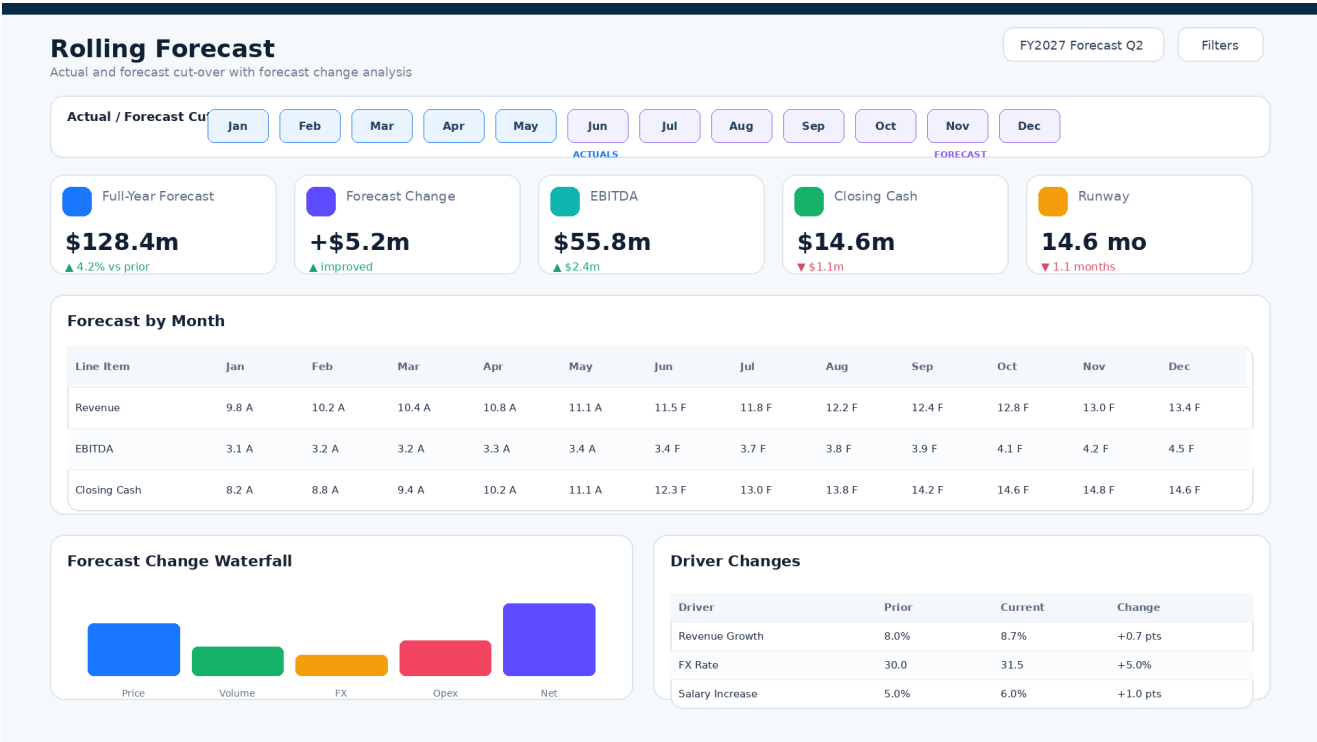
Planning Worksheet: high-density monthly grid, controlled actual/forecast cells, cell detail, comments, driver assumptions and workflow progress.

UI 3 - Annual Budget Department Workspace

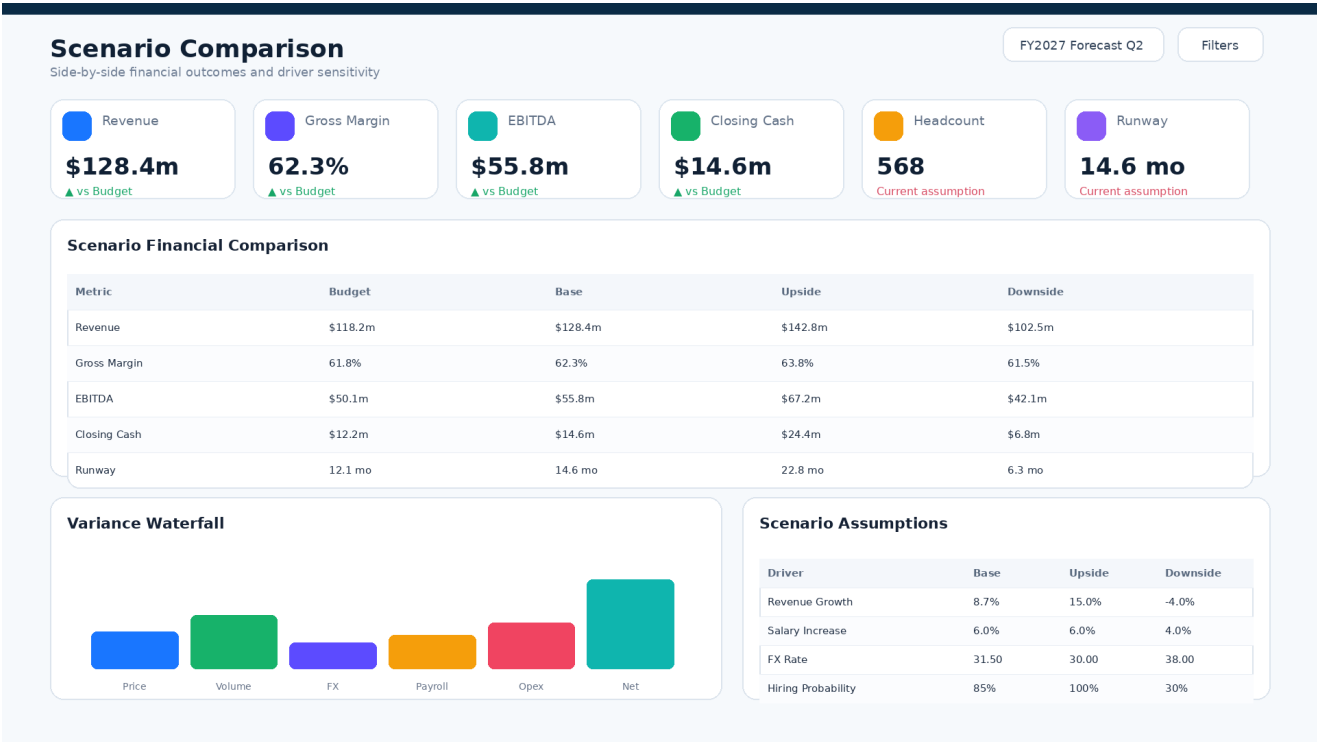


Annual Budget Department Workspace: planning areas, department budget grid, validation issues, tasks and submission controls.

UI 4 - Rolling Forecast Workspace



UI 5 - Scenario Comparison



UI 6 - Assumptions and Driver Library

Assumptions & Driver Library

Controlled business assumptions, approvals and calculation impact

FY2027 Forecast Q2

Filters

Active Drivers

128

▲ 6 this quarter

Pending Approval

7

Needs review

Material Changes

4

Above threshold

Forecast Impact

+\$8.2m

Current selected changes

Driver Register

Driver	Category	Prior	Current	Owner	Status
Revenue Growth	Revenue	8.0%	8.7%	Nyasha Chikore	Approved
USD/ZIG Rate	FX	30.0	31.5	Tendai Moyo	Approved
Salary Increase	Payroll	5.0%	6.0%	Rudo Nyathi	Pending
Collection Days	Cash	45	52	Tinashe Ncube	Pending
Rent Escalation	Expense	6.0%	8.0%	Rutendo Dube	Approved
Hiring Probability	Workforce	75%	85%	Nyasha Chikore	Draft

Selected Driver

Salary Increase

Current proposed value

6.0%

Materiality Threshold

10% relative change

Affected Calculations

- Payroll Expense
- EBITDA
- Operating Cash Flow
- Closing Cash
- Cash Runway

Reject

Approve

Assumptions and Driver Library: driver register, history, materiality, impacted calculations and approval controls.

UI 7 - Workforce Planning

Workforce Planning

Headcount, hiring probability and payroll cost planning

FY2027 Forecast Q2

Filters

Opening HC

512

Current baseline

New Hires

74

85% weighted

Planned Exits

18

Approved

Closing HC

568

▲ 56 vs Budget

Payroll

\$29.3m

▲ 6.4%

Employee and Position Plan

Employee / Position	Department	Status	Start Date	Annual Salary	Probability
Senior Developer	Technology	Vacancy	01 Jul 2027	\$54,000	85%
Data Analyst	FP&A	Vacancy	01 Aug 2027	\$42,000	75%
Business Development Mgr	Sales	Vacancy	15 Jun 2027	\$48,000	90%
Rudo Nyathi	Technology	Active	01 Jan 2026	\$72,000	100%
Tariro Moyo	Sales	Active	01 Jan 2025	\$66,000	100%
Nyasha Chikore	Marketing	Active	01 Jan 2025	\$63,000	100%

Selected Hire

Senior Developer

Department

Technology

Start Date

01 Jul 2027

Annual Salary

\$54,000

Benefits

18%

Hiring Probability

85%

Expected FY Cost

\$22,950

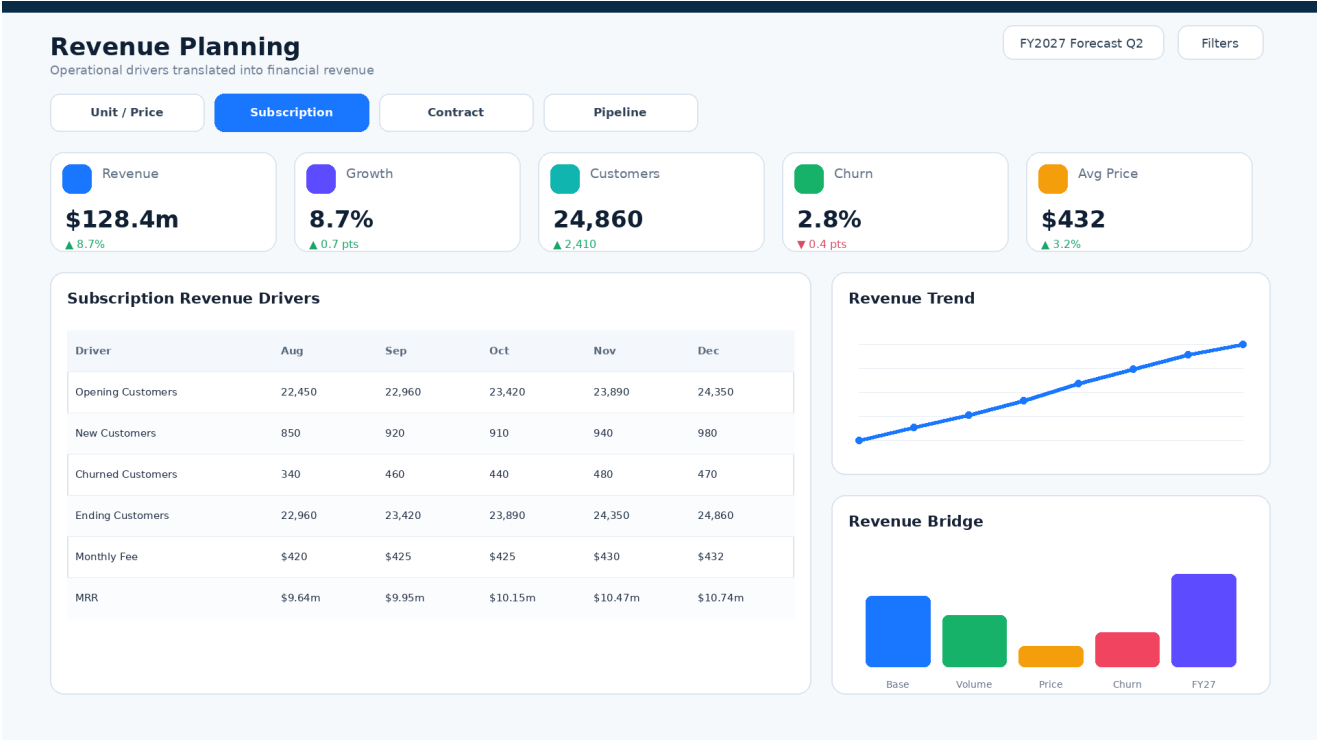
View Financial Impact

Workforce Planning: current workforce, proposed positions, hiring probability and forecast payroll impact.

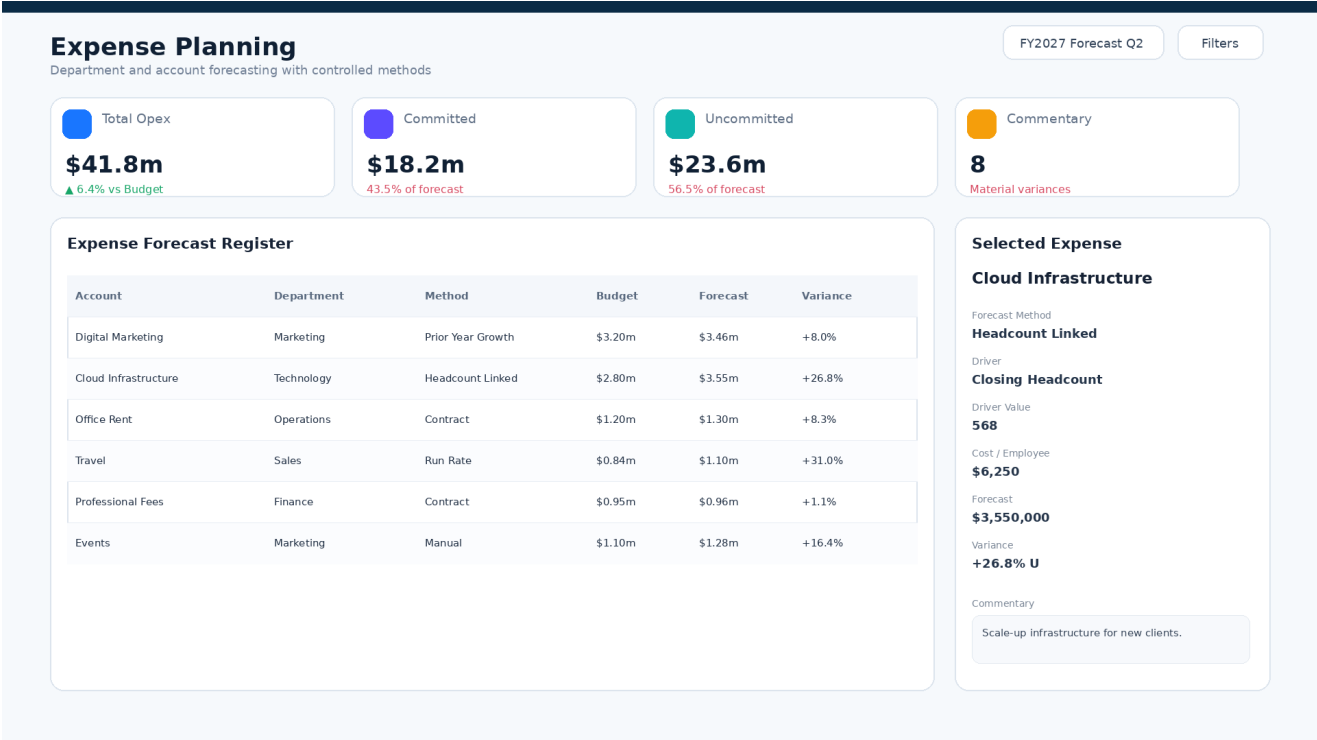
UI 8 - Revenue Planning

Software Requirements Document

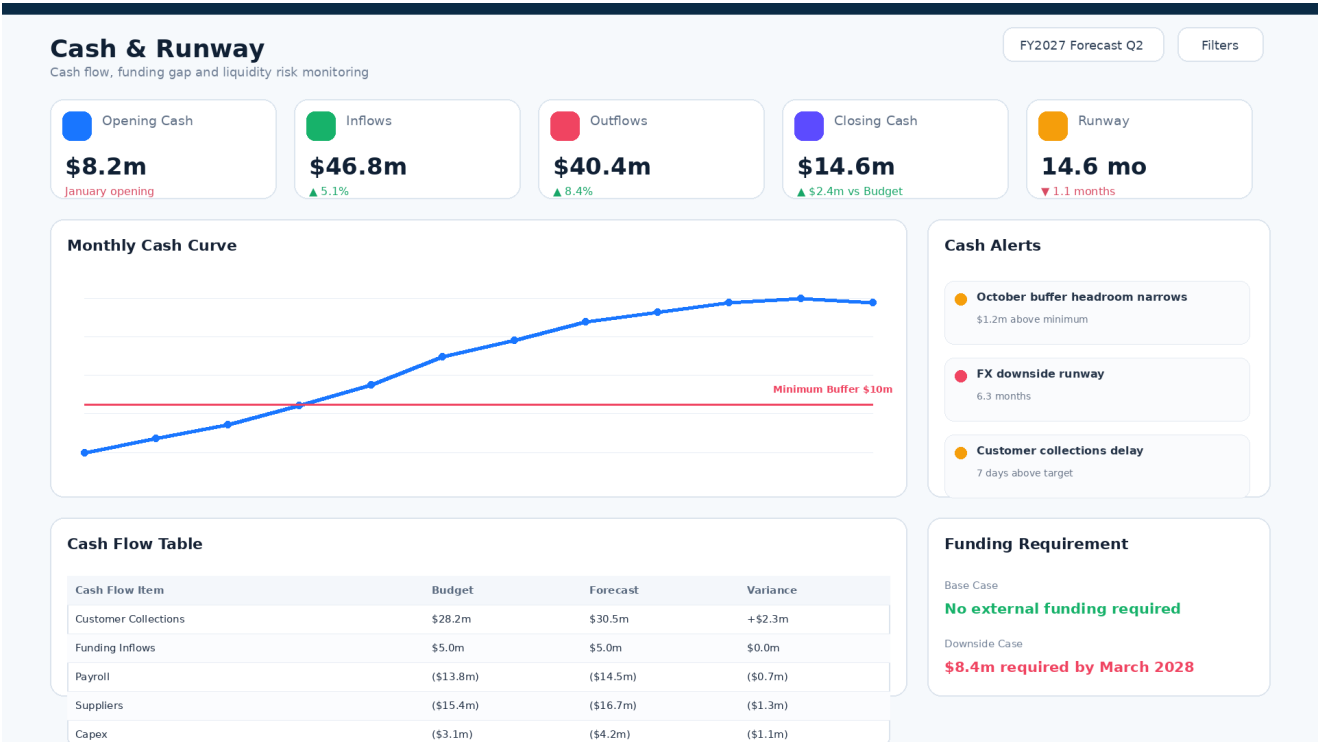
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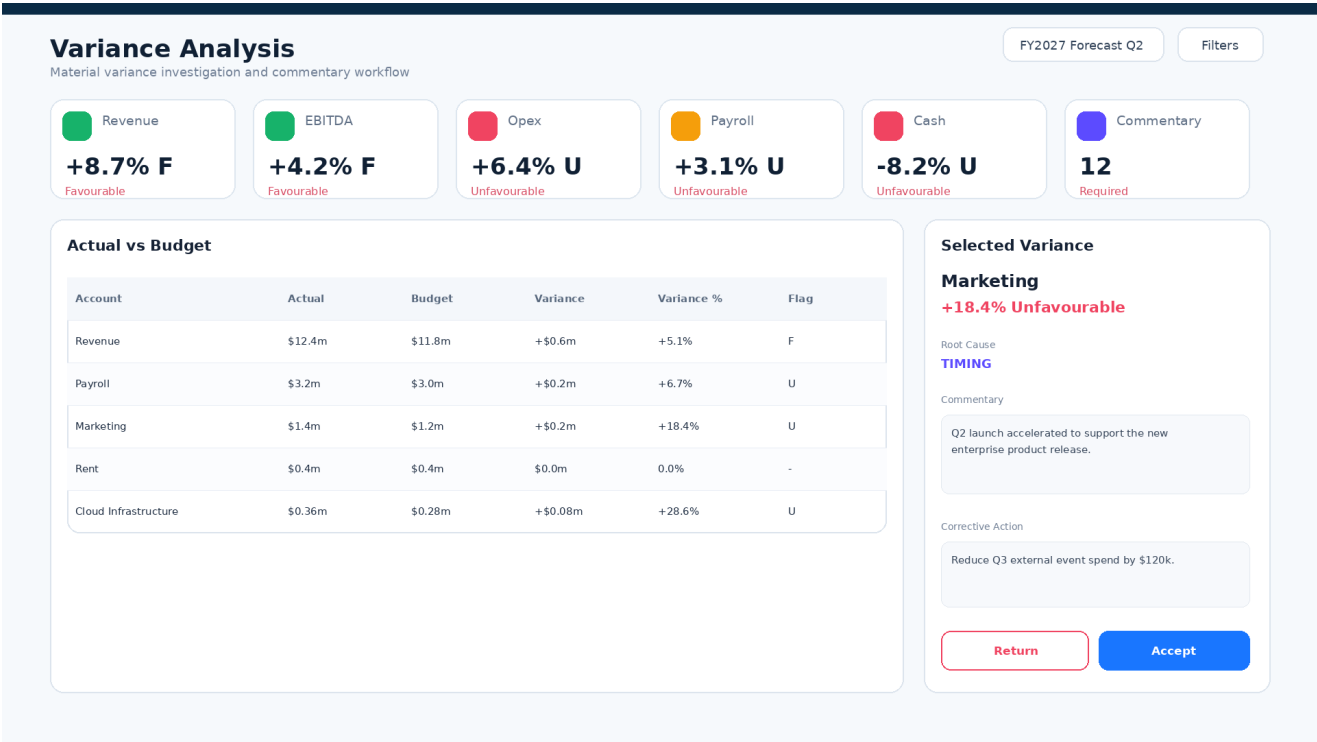


UI 9 - Expense Planning



UI 10 - Cash and Runway





21. Rolling horizons can extend automatically.
22. Users can create scenarios.
23. Scenarios may inherit from a parent scenario.
24. Scenario overrides do not duplicate all planning values.
25. Users can compare several scenarios.
26. Scenarios can be promoted to new working forecast versions.
27. Driver values retain history.
28. Material driver changes can require approval.
29. Workforce planning calculates headcount and payroll impact.
30. Revenue planning supports several forecasting methods.
31. Expense planning supports driver and contract-based methods.
32. Capex planning updates cash and depreciation.
33. Working-capital planning affects collection and payment timing.
34. Cash planning calculates opening and closing cash.
35. Cash runway handles cash-generative businesses correctly.
36. Portfolio-company forecasts require review before official FP&A import.
37. Actuals imports create controlled snapshots.
38. Source-to-FP&A mapping exceptions are visible.
39. Variance analysis supports actual versus budget and forecast.
40. Favourable and unfavourable logic is configurable.
41. Currency variance can be distinguished from operating variance.
42. Material variances can create commentary tasks.
43. Variance commentary supports review and return.
44. Workflow supports Draft, Submitted, Review, Approved and Locked.
45. Maker-checker rules are enforced by the API.
46. Management reports reference explicit planning versions.
47. Board packs use approved or locked data.
48. AI suggestions require human acceptance.
49. Concurrent planning edits do not silently overwrite one another.
50. Every material planning and approval event is auditable.

43. FINAL PRODUCT DEFINITION

The completed Arcus FP&A Planning, Budgeting, Forecasting and Scenario Modelling System must provide finance teams with one controlled environment for understanding the future financial position of an organisation.

The system must allow management to begin with actual operational and financial information, apply controlled business assumptions, calculate the resulting financial outlook, compare alternative futures and formally approve the financial plan used for management and Board decision-making.

ACTUALS

Tell us what happened.

DRIVERS

Explain what management believes will happen.

THE MODEL

Translates assumptions into financial outcomes.

THE FORECAST

Shows the current expected future.

SCENARIOS

Show what could happen under different assumptions.

VARIANCE ANALYSIS

Explains what changed and why.

WORKFLOW

Determines who reviews and approves the plan.

THE LOCKED VERSION

Defines the approved financial record.

The final system must feel familiar enough for a finance professional who currently works in Excel, but it must provide the calculation integrity, dimensional structure, version control, collaboration, security and auditability expected from a professional enterprise FP&A platform.